

The Books Kept at 3 Washington Square North

*Josephine Nivison Hopper's record of Edward Hopper's work,
read from the six artist's ledgers and four notebooks
at the Whitney Museum of American Art*

A critical note
Draft of 13 September 2026

*Made using AI: the transcriptions were read from the Whitney's photographs by Claude Opus
5 and Fable 5.1,
and this note was drafted by Claude Fable 5.1 from those transcriptions, under the direction
of Michel Hua.
No person has yet checked either against the sheets.*

Written from the Hopper Ledgers transcriptions at <https://hopper.commutator.io>
(Whitney Museum of American Art, 96.208 to 96.213, and the Sanborn Hopper Archive, Series
IV.A)

Working draft; a shorter article drawn from it is being prepared for the *Journal of the Text
Encoding Initiative*.

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Hopper quoted in it are © Heirs of Josephine N. Hopper, licensed by Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York,
and are quoted for criticism and study; the data behind the tables and figures are CC0 in the edition's
repository. This is a working draft, not a publication.

Abstract

The six artist's ledgers of Edward and Josephine Hopper at the Whitney Museum of American Art, 504 digitised sheets kept from 1913 to 1967, and four of Josephine Hopper's notebooks from the Sanborn Hopper Archive were transcribed in September 2026 by a language model, sheet by sheet against the museum's photographs, into a restricted LaTeX with a critical apparatus that marks what was read, what was doubted, what could not be read and whose hand wrote it. This note reads that transcription whole. It describes the ten books and the division of labour between the two hands; follows each ledger through its prices, buyers, exhibitions and descriptions; reads the notebooks as the other half of the same working life; derives from the leaves a chronology of the painter's materials and a census of his formats; and adds up, under stated rules, what the books say was charged and received over fifty-four years. Every quotation is cited by leaf and by the museum's reference and hyperlinked to the transcribed sheet beside its photograph; every figure is a floor under a published rule. The note argues that the edition's contribution is a condition rather than a finding, that any sentence read from these books can now be checked against the hand it came out of on one screen, and it presents itself as an experiment in that method, made with the Hopper corpus as its occasion and with the model's reading, still unchecked by a person, left in view. The methodology chapter sets out the pipeline, from the harvested inventory to the accounts readers, and the working method: Claude Code with Opus 5 and Fable 5.1, a GitHub repository as workbench, an interface built for checking, and parallel sessions by remote control.

Keywords. Edward Hopper; Josephine Nivison Hopper; artist's ledgers; transcription; critical apparatus; TEI; machine reading; provenance; art market; digital humanities.

Data availability. The transcriptions, the derived data, the site and the sources of this note are in the public repository at <https://github.com/Commutator-IO/hopper-project>, the site at <https://hopper.commutator.io>; the transcriptions are also exported as TEI P5. A Zenodo deposit with a DOI is planned and is tracked as issue 16 of that repository; until it exists, the repository at a named commit is the citable form. The photographs are the Whitney Museum's and are served from its own ResourceSpace; none is stored by the edition.

A note on this critical note

This is an experiment, and the Hopper ledgers are its excuse. What is being tried is a way of working: a language model reading an archive sheet by sheet under stated rules, a person building the instrument that puts the reading beside the photograph so it can be checked, a repository that keeps every reading, rule and figure as a dated commit, and, at the end, the same model asked to write up what the archive says. The ledgers were chosen because they are the right size for a test, five hundred sheets in one hand with numbers in them that either add up or do not, and because the Whitney serves the photographs openly. Whatever this note says about Edward and Josephine Hopper is secondary to that, and should be read as a demonstration of what the method produces at first pass, with its errors left in, rather than as a contribution to the literature on the painter.

This is a critical note, combining synthesis of the ten books, analysis of the data derived from them, and an evaluation of what the record is and is not. It is a draft of a particular kind. It was made using artificial intelligence, and that has to be said first. The transcription it rests on was made by a language model, Claude Opus 5 and Claude Fable 5.1, reading the Whitney's photographs sheet by sheet in September 2026; the note itself was drafted by Claude Fable 5.1 on 13 September 2026, from those transcriptions and from the data files derived from them, at the request and under the direction of Michel Hua, who set the task and the scope but has not yet read every sentence against the leaves. Eight parallel readings of the transcripts, each by the same model, supplied the quotations and the figures; the prose, the selection and the argument are the model's. A reader should treat the whole as the work of a careful research assistant whose notes have not been checked, which is what it is. Two exceptions are recorded where they occur: the two quotations the argument leans on hardest, the Goethe line under October on Cape Cod and the sentence of Edward Hopper's purpose in the black notebook, were compared with the Whitney's photographs of those two sheets by the model on 13 September 2026, at the museum's published resolution, and the readings held; that is a machine's comparison and not the human check the edition reserves the word *checked* for. It is written from a transcription of the six Hopper ledgers and four of Josephine Hopper's notebooks that was made, sheet by sheet, against the Whitney Museum's photographs, and it is written before any person has checked that transcription against the photographs sheet by sheet. Every quotation below is therefore a quotation of a *reading*, and the reading is dated. Where I quote the leaves I quote them as the transcription gives them, with Josephine Hopper's spelling, her abbreviations and her arithmetic intact, and I give the leaf number she wrote on the paper and the resource reference the museum assigned to the photograph, because the first is what a reader holding the volume can find and the second is the only number that names exactly one image.

The figures are of the same kind. Where I say that the pictures of a year sold for so much, I mean that the rows of the transcribed leaves, read by a reader whose rules are stated, add up to so much; I do not mean that Edward Hopper earned it. The distinction

is not modesty. A ledger row with a price in it looks like data in a way a sentence of prose does not, and it will be cited as data whatever caveats stand beside it. So the tables in the appendix carry the date they were generated, and every total in the text is a floor under a number nobody yet knows.

Three readers stand before this one and nothing here claims priority over them. Gail Levin wrote the biography from the diaries and the catalogue raisonn  from the record books; Deborah Lyons published the record books in 1997; Madeleine Larson typed the Provincetown diaries. Most of what a first reading of these leaves finds surprising is in Levin already. What this draft can add is not a discovery but a method: the reading placed beside the sheet, so that any sentence in it can be checked against the hand it came out of.

A shorter article drawn from this draft is being prepared for the *Journal of the Text Encoding Initiative*, an open-access journal, and this draft is written to its expectation that the method, the data and the text be open, and that any use of generative AI be declared, as it is here. The note itself is therefore licensed under Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC BY 4.0): it may be copied, redistributed and built upon for any purpose, provided the source is credited. The licence covers the prose, the tables, the figures and the LaTeX sources in the edition's repository. It does not and cannot cover three things, which stay under their own terms: the data files the tables and figures are read from, which the repository dedicates to the public domain under CC0 and which need no attribution at all; the coordinates in the travels figure, which are OpenStreetMap's under the ODbL; and the words of Josephine and Edward Hopper, which remain in copyright. They are quoted here for the purpose of criticism and study, in the quantities that purpose requires, and this document is a working paper and not a publication.

Conventions. A citation of the form Book II, leaf 95, ref 17982 names the volume, the leaf as numbered on the paper, and the Whitney's ResourceSpace reference for the photograph. Notebooks are cited by page and reference. Quoted matter from the leaves is set between guillemets, «like this», and the writer's own quotation marks inside it are shown as curly double quotes; italics inside a quotation are the writer's own underlining; *[illegible]* marks a passage the transcriber could not read; a superscript query marks a reading the transcriber offered as doubtful. Struck-through text was struck through in the book. Nothing inside a quotation has been corrected. Every leaf citation is a hyperlink to the transcribed sheet beside its photograph on the edition's site, and every notebook citation to the notebook's reading view. The works discussed are shown as schemas of their composition in main masses only, black and white, at the proportions of the size in Edward Hopper's hand and with a link to the holding museum's own page: the images are in copyright and are not reproduced, and the schemas are the writer's reductions, made from the leaf's description and general knowledge of the picture, not tracings. The figures redraw, from the same data files, the drawings the site makes, and each is signed.

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Ten books and two hands

1.1 *What the books are*

On the inside front cover of the first of the six ledgers, in a small upright running hand, Josephine Nivison Hopper wrote what the books were for:

Recorded by Jo N Hopper (Mrs. Edward Hopper) at time each work is finished, or before it leaves studio. Drawings in the 3 books done by Edward Hopper.

The second volume repeats the statement in a shorter form, in the same hand, inside a hand-drawn frame with bracketed corners that also carries the address, «Edward Hopper / 3 Washington Square North / New York City / — / His Work. / Vol. II. »: «Recorded by Jo N. Hopper (Mrs. Edward Hopper.) before each work leaves studio. Drawings by Edward Hopper.» (Book II, inside cover, ref 17362). The word «each» is squeezed in above the line, between «before» and «work», which is the first of several thousand corrections she would make to her own record over forty years.

The statement is worth pausing on because it is a claim about method, and the whole documentary value of the archive turns on whether it is true. It says that the record was made at the moment the work left the studio, not reconstructed afterwards; that the drawings are his and everything else is hers; and that there are three books of that kind. All three claims are borne out by the leaves, and all three need qualifying.

There are six volumes at the Whitney, accessioned as 96.208 to 96.213, and they are not all of one kind. Three of them are the «3 books» of the inside cover: Book I (96.208), which begins with the etchings one plate to a leaf and then, from leaf 45, turns into running lists; Book II (96.209), the paintings one to an opening, with Edward Hopper's ink record sketch and Josephine Hopper's description opposite; and Book III (96.210), the last of the work books, which runs to his death in 1967 and carries the latest hand in the archive. The fourth, Book IV (96.211), is something else altogether: a stationer's pocket memorandum book, seven and a half inches by four and three-quarters, with no sketches and no anecdote, kept without a gap from 15 November 1913 to 23 March 1967. The fifth, Book V (96.212), is sixteen sheets of drawings and etchings, 1953 to 1963, which declares on its own index leaf, «This book for drawings, not water colors.» (Book V, index, ref 16748). And the sixth, Dealers/Etchings (96.213), is a cash book whose front half was used for something else, so that its leaves begin at 51, and which is indexed, as the transcription's header puts it, «by whose hands the work was in» rather than by which work it was.

The three work books were the gift of Lloyd Goodrich; Book IV was a purchase, and the dealers' book a purchase with funds from an anonymous donor. That the friend who organised the retrospectives of 1950 and 1964 should have owned the record books is not surprising, and it is part of the history of the archive that the books were consulted, and

their figures copied, by the museum long before they came to it. Josephine Hopper's own diary records, on 24 June 1948, that «Miss Irven bragged that she had all the data from my ledger, so they can go right ahead & put their figures on everything» (PAAM typescript, Part V); Rosalind Irvine of the Whitney was preparing the 1950 retrospective, and the ledger she had the data from is Book II.

Beside the six ledgers, the Whitney's Sanborn Hopper Archive holds, by the museum's own count, ninety notebooks of Josephine Hopper's. Four of them have been digitised, and those four are read here: the notebook she titled «Garrulities + Grouch» and subtitled «When artists meet» (1924–1950, 42 sheets); two notebooks of 1947 on the fight with New York University over the house at 3 Washington Square North, one headed «Re: 3 Wash Sq» (51 sheets) and the other «Battle of Wash Sq.» (8 sheets); and a black two-ring notebook of about 1952 to 1961 (68 sheets) that is not a diary at all but a book of lists: frames and their makers, insurance, paper by the pound, addresses, mailing lists, a recipe, and two chronicles of the years, one kept forwards and one backwards. The remaining diaries, twenty-two of them at the Provincetown Art Association and Museum and the rest at the Whitney, are not in this corpus and are used here only through Madeleine Larson's typescript of the Provincetown volumes, which the Timeline of the edition cites page by page.

1.2 Whose hand

The division of labour the inside cover announces is real and it is visible on every leaf. Edward Hopper's contribution to the record books is the drawing and its caption: a small pen sketch of the finished picture, ruled into a box, in bold strokes and close cross-hatching, and above or beside it the title and the size in drawn lettering. The size is the one figure in the archive that he wrote himself, and it is also the only quantity in it that measures an object rather than reporting an event. Everything else is hers: the description, the paint formula, the sale, the exhibitions, the juries, the reproductions, the dealer's third, the date the cheque cleared, and the corrections above the line, and the pencil afterthoughts made ten, twenty and thirty years later.

Even this needs a qualification. The transcription attributes hands cautiously, and it refuses to attribute the drawn lettering of the covers to either of them «until somebody has compared it against a signed drawing». More importantly, Book IV, the cash book, is in a hand the transcriber could not place: the first batch of it is «a fluent, sloping copperplate, unlike either the small upright running hand or the drawn title lettering recorded from Books I to III», and its entries begin in November 1913, eleven years before Josephine Nivison entered the account. Whoever kept the cash book in the illustration years, it was not the woman who later kept the work books, and the edition marks every passage of those early leaves as unidentified. The hand that begins the archive is a hand nobody has named.

Later hands are few and they are worth listing, because each is a moment when the record passed out of the household. «Given by Helen Hayes to Smith College» under The MacArthurs' Home (Book II, leaf 77, ref 17681); «John Clancy cited value for insurance \$15000 - 1964» under Office at Night (Book II, leaf 79, ref 16494); a heavier blunt pencil on leaf 46 of Book II recording a resale through Maynard Walker in 1956. These are the

traces of the dealer, the buyer and the museum reading the book after the Hoppers had stopped writing in it.

1.3 What a leaf is

A leaf of the work books has a shape, and the shape is an argument about what a picture is. At the head, the title and the size in his hand. Below it the drawing. Under the drawing a line of paint: the colourman, the canvas and its priming, the white, the oil, the thinner. Then the description in her hand, which on the early leaves is an anecdote about the people in the picture and on the later leaves is a note of what colour everything is. Then the sale: buyer, price, « - 1/3 = » the net, the date. Then the exhibitions and their verdicts, the reproductions, the prizes, and whatever she thought of afterwards. A picture, on this evidence, is an object of a certain size, made of certain materials, showing certain people, that went to certain places and was paid for on a certain day. It is not an idea, and it is not a feeling, and the record is nearly silent about what its maker meant by it. That silence is the subject of half of what follows.

The etchings leaves of Book I are ruled differently, and the ruling matters. Their columns read «Date | accepted / Refused | Exhibitions | Sold to, and terms | Received», so that the first column dates the exhibition and not the sale, and one line carries an impression's whole history from jury to cheque. A refusal is recorded as carefully as an acceptance, one letter in its own narrow column, and the National Academy of Design, the transcription's glossary observes, «is the body that refused him most often». Book IV is ruled by the stationer into a date column, a description column and a money column divided into dollars and cents by two printed red rules, and nobody heads a column anywhere in its 159 leaves.

1.4 How the reading was made

The claim this note makes is stated here so that every chapter can be measured against it: what the edition adds to the study of these books is not a finding but a condition, that any sentence read from them can be checked against the photograph of the leaf it came from, on one screen, by anybody. The transcription this study is written from was made in September 2026 by a language model, in batches of twelve sheets, each batch a fresh reading with a header that says what the batch covers, what was hard about it and what was decided. It is a first pass, and it says so on every file. A critical apparatus marks what was read, what was guessed, what could not be read and whose hand it was; nothing illegible is guessed, because, as the edition's method page puts it, «a guessed figure is a sale that did not happen». The transcribed text is the source of record; the tables, the counts and the timeline are derived from it by scripts whose rules are published, and every figure in this study can be traced to a row.

I say this not to praise the method but to fix the status of what follows. The quotations are accurate to a reading that may be wrong in detail and that a second reader is expected to correct. The figures are accurate to rules that are stated and that a second reader may reject. What cannot be wrong, because it does not rest on any reading, is the shape of the

Ten books and two hands

archive: two hands, ten books, fifty-four years, and a woman recording, in a voice that is unmistakably her own, the work of a man who would not talk about it.

Chapter 2

Book I: the plates, and the lists that grew behind them

2.1 *A Woolworth ledger*

The first of the three work books is the humblest object in the archive and the one that says most about how the record began. Its cover is a Woolworth «S. E. LEDGER»; its title page still carries the stationer's label, «HERALD SQUARE / Account Book / No. 2041 ... Made Expressly for F. W. Woolworth Co. », and beneath the label, in her hand, the statement of method already quoted. The transcriber's note on that sheet is four words long and is the right response: «It says three books; six survive.» Inside the front cover a Berenice Abbott halftone portrait of the painter is hinged to the board; on the sheet after it, in drawn lettering the edition leaves unattributed, «Book I. », and in her cursive, «From 1913» (Book I, title, ref 17616; 16250).

The index on leaf 1 is the map of the volume and it is also the first evidence of a habit that runs through everything she wrote: the record is arranged, re-arranged and cross-referenced by its keeper, over decades, until the arrangement is itself a document. Etchings 2–47; Early Work, Paris Oils 50; Oils 52; Water colors by year 60–78; Notes 45–49; Etchings at Rehn 76; Current Exhibitions 84; Prizes 94–95; Reviews 98; Gifts 99; Reproductions 96–98; Photographs 92–93; and «Drawings» struck through with «+ Book IV for drawings» beside it, which is not the Book IV the Whitney numbered but the book of drawings the museum calls Book V (Book I, leaf 1, ref 16800). Beneath the page table is a two-column list of the etching plates with two prices against each, the second replacing the first; and in the margin, «More complete list for Carl [illegible] in [illegible] inside front cover - Feb. 14, 1961 », which is Carl Zigrosser of the Philadelphia Museum, a year before Philadelphia bought the whole output of the press.

On the same leaf stands the sentence the transcriber calls «the key to the whole of Book I»:

Notation in ink at right side of page is date when check received by E.H. from the Rehn Gallery. Pencil note means when picture sold to buyer.

Ink is the cheque; pencil is the sale. It is a rule about media, and it means that the colour of the writing on these leaves carries information that a transcription in one typeface loses unless it says so. The edition says so, leaf by leaf, and this study depends on it.

2.2 *One plate to a leaf*

Leaves 2 to 44 hold the etchings, one plate to an odd leaf with the record continuing on the even leaf behind it. At the head of each is a halftone of the print, hinged; beside it the title and the plate size in Edward Hopper's drawn lettering, «the only words on this leaf in the other hand», as the note on Evening Wind puts it (Book I, leaf 2, ref 16853). Then thirty or forty ruled lines in her hand, under headings that vary from leaf to leaf and are transcribed as they vary: Date, accepted / Refused, Exhibitions, Sold to and terms, Amount, when received; and below a red rule a second band for resales, «Date of sale / amt. rec'd / Sold by whom - to whom» (Book I, leaf 18, ref 17168).

What these leaves record, first of all, is a career of submission. The narrow column of «A» and «R» runs from a Los Angeles print jury in January 1921 through the Brooklyn Society of Etchers, the Chicago Society, the Print Club of Philadelphia, the National Academy of Design, and the refusals are entered as carefully as the acceptances. In the margin of the first plate leaf, in her hand, is the sentence that closes that career: «After 1926 nothing sent to juries» (Book I, leaf 2, ref 16853). Rehn had taken him on in the autumn of 1924; by 1926 the juries were no longer needed.

The prices tell the same story in figures, and they are worth setting out because they are the clearest series in the archive. In 1919 Les Poilus went to Carl Smalley for eight dollars (Book I, leaf 41, ref 18062). In 1921 the Monhegan Boat went to the State Library at Los Angeles for eighteen, of which \$16.20 arrived; the Bull Fight was «\$22 - 10%» in May of that year; Les Deux Pigeons sold at Weyhe's book shop at «\$15 - 40%», nine dollars to the artist (Book I, leaf 40, ref 17668). In 1922 and 1923 the discounts are the story: Mrs. Sterner «30% out of 18» = 12.60; Sidney Phillips «\$18 - 50%» = 9; the Brooklyn Museum «\$22 - 15%» = 18.70; House Tops at «\$15 - 33 1/3%» = \$10 and, at the Whitney Studio Club, «No commission 15» (Book I, leaf 32, ref 16428). In 1924 the New Republic paid «Use of plate \$100» and «Royalties 150» for the portfolio (Book I, leaf 6, ref 16548). In May 1925 the Metropolitan bought fifteen etchings as a group through William Ivins at ten dollars a print, an accession the museum still lists as lot 25.31. From 1927 the terms settle at a third to the dealer on twenty-five dollars, «25 - 1/3» = 16 2/3, and in the autumn of 1929 at thirty, «30 - 1/3» = 20, which is what an impression of Evening Wind or Night Shadows cost for the next twenty years. In 1945, «Price raised to 50 - last few prints of Edition» (Book I, leaf 3, ref 17443). In June 1949 the Carnegie bought eleven prints for \$300, «average of 27.27 - 1/3 Rehn Gal. = \$18»; and on 2 February 1962 the Philadelphia Museum bought, as she wrote on leaf 44, the «large collection of etchings & dry points in various states», with seven preliminary drawings valued at five and six hundred dollars each, which the transcriber observes are «the only figures in Book I that are not sale prices, and they are forty times the prices on the leaves around them» (Book I, leaf 44, ref 18288).

Forty years, then, from eight dollars to thirty, and the plate itself, when a museum finally valued it, at six hundred. An etcher's economy is small and the book knows it. One leaf records a sale to the British Museum, in pencil, in a later hand: «Given to Fuller Brush man, friend of Rabbitfoot⁷ - queer Dick - Sold Etching of E.H. - Night Shadows to British Mus. ... 1£ - then \$5 - so it could be listed as a sale. ... Curator there liked etching but no funds to buy» (Book I, leaf 89, ref 18152). A pound and then five dollars, so that it could be listed as a sale: the sentence is about the record as much as about the money, and it is

one of many places where she is visibly keeping the book for the museum that would one day read it.

Her own queries about her own bookkeeping stand on the leaves. Beside a Weyhe row on leaf 7: «could this be a duplicate note?» (Book I, leaf 7, ref 16439). On the leaf of unlisted watercolours: «Could this be Shipyard, Rockland - schooner Butterfly? p. 64.» and, of Pretty Penny, «Owned by Jo Hopper?» (Book I, leaf 72, ref 18117). On the Rehn etchings leaf: «19 Etchings to Utica Art Soc. Rudolph Tandler - where are they now?» (Book I, leaf 77, ref 18222). These are not errors in the record; they are the record recording its own limits, and a reader who wants to know how reliable the ledgers are should begin with the fact that their keeper did not always know.

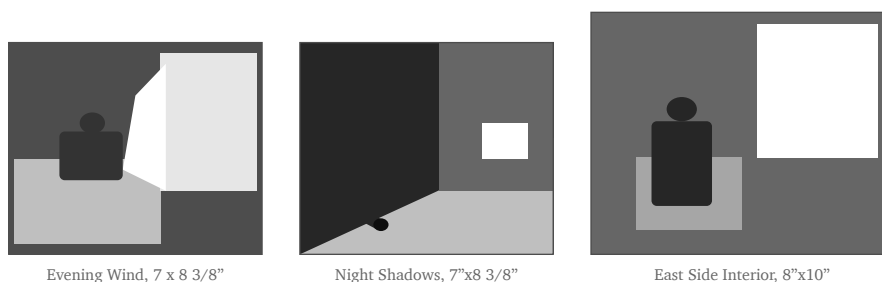


Figure 2.1: **Evening Wind**, etching, 1921, 7 x 8 3/8" as the leaf writes it (Book I, leaf 2, ref 16853). The Metropolitan Museum of Art, 25.31.7: <https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/366211>. **Night Shadows**, etching, 1921, 7"x8 3/8" as the leaf writes it (Book I, leaf 6, ref 16548). The Metropolitan Museum of Art, 25.31.2: <https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/366206>. **East Side Interior**, etching, 1922, 8"x10" as the leaf writes it (Book I, leaf 8, ref 17539). The Metropolitan Museum of Art, 25.31.1: <https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/366204>. Scale: ten inches to four centimetres, four times the scale of the canvases in the other figures. The drawings are schemas of the composition in its main masses only, at the proportions of the size in Edward Hopper's hand, made from the leaf's description and from general knowledge of the picture; nothing is traced and no detail is drawn, and they are not reproductions. The pictures themselves are at the museums' own pages. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from the transcriptions and works.json (2026-09-13).

2.3 *The oils, written up afterwards*

From leaf 45 the volume changes character, and the change is instructive. She had a plate-by-plate book; she needed somewhere for everything else; and so the second half of Book I became, in no fixed order, a set of running lists: Notes and Explanations, Pre-Rehn Sales, Etching Collections, One Man Shows, Paris Paintings, Paris Watercolors, Oils 1913–1931 by year, Water Colors 1923–1931 by year, Etchings at the Rehn Gallery, Current Exhibitions 1923–1943, Reviews and Reproductions, Photographs, Prizes and Museum Purchases, Gifts, a page of accounts turned ninety degrees, and, on the back flyleaf, a chronology of the summers from 1923 to 1963. Several of these runs are bound back to front, because she filled a recto and then used the leaf before it for the overflow; the edition transcribes them in binding order and says so.

The oils leaves (52 to 59, 80 and 81) are where the early career is written up, and they are written up *afterwards*: the watercolour leaves of 1924 to 1926 carry, in a later ink, the resales of June 1962, on rows first written forty years before. Here is the first canvas sold,

twice over. On leaf 45: «Bought out of famous Armory Sale 1913 — NewYork — by — Geo. Vietor. Sold by Arthur B. Davies.» and «This the first oil sold — (turned up in fall of 1949 — in different frame.)» On leaf 52, Sailing, «Sold at International Armory Show 1913 — \$225» and then «Sold to Mr. Vietor, 25" & Mad. Ave. 250 - 10%», with «Sold by Arthur B. Davies» struck out (Book I, leaf 52, ref 18056). Book II gives «± \$250», the dealers' book \$200, and the discrepancy is not a scandal: it is what a record made from memory looks like when it is made three times.

The oils prices climb where the etchings did not. Apartment Houses to the Pennsylvania Academy, \$340 net, 1925. House by a Railroad: «Price \$750, reduced to 600 - 1/3 Com. \$400» to Stephen Clark in March 1926, and on the line below, «Given to the Museum of Modern Art», where it is accession 3.1930, credited «Given anonymously». Sunday, «Bgt. by Duncan Phillips for \$600 !», the exclamation hers. The Automat, 1200 less a third in 1927, 800 to the painter. Two on the Aisle, 1500 and 1000. Blackwell's Island, 2500 and 1666.67 in 1929. Tables for Ladies to the Metropolitan, «4500 - 1/3 3000 June 3, 1931». Early Sunday Morning, then still «7th Ave. Shops» with «later named Early Sun. Morning» in her hand, 3000 less a third, 2000, to the Whitney on 5 May 1934. And in the 1950s the same leaves take the resales: Barber Shop to Roy Neuberger at \$4000 in 1954, Hotel Room to the Spingolds at 5500 in 1955.

On the Ex Lax leaf the descriptive habit becomes something else, an anecdote about a title:

It was suggested that E. Hopper change name to ES LAX. But the 2 X's in Ex Lax compose so much better, E. H. just made the change in water color. So soon after this, the canvas was bought by J. Spalding (Boston) who had no scruples about EX LAX, so water color S — removed. But in meantime the picture had been photographed as Es Lax, & reproduced somewhere, & discovered by the Ex Lax people themselves, who wrote asking that the right name be used with their blessing. (Book I, leaf 45, ref 16318)

The two X's compose better: it is the painter's reason, reported by his wife, and it is the nearest thing in Book I to a statement of what he thought a picture was for.

Tables for Ladies gets the fullest description in the volume, and it shows the habit in its early, anecdotal form: «"Olga", very blond, fine looking waitress all in white apron with bow in back. Cherry stained wood work + tiled floor. Cashier, Anna Popalgopalos² in black at desk, Max Scherer² + wife Sadie at table L. rear.» (Book I, leaf 59, ref 16991). The figures have names, and the names are hers; the transcriber marks two of them as doubtful readings, which is correct, but the doubt is about the letters and not about the fact that she named them. Capt. Ed Staples has a leaf of his own history: «"Honest Man in front of his Honest House" - Cleveland Plain Dealer - Summer 1929», then «Burnt up in railroad accident on way back from Cleveland Museum - Summer 1929», then «Insurance rec'd 2/3 assessed value 1000 Nov. 2 1929» (Book I, leaf 55, ref 17525). A watercolour that a buyer's wife would not have, Two Lights Village, is returned because «wife didn't like out house» and exchanged for Civil War Camp Ground (Book I, leaf 66, ref 16820). Adam's House is «Presented to Frank + Peggy Rehn - Nov. 12, 1936. on the occasion of looking over the long list of sales made by them for E. H.» (Book I, leaf 67, ref 17040). Railroad Sunset: «A real beauty this one.» and «Given to Jo Hopper - along with Jo Painting - anniversary present 1955. Signed statement of this in bank box - J.H.» (Book I, leaf 58, ref 18297).

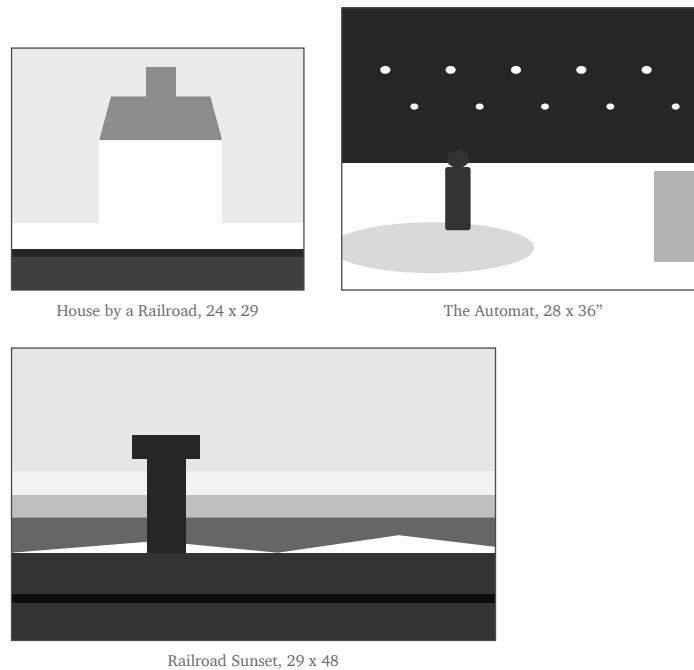
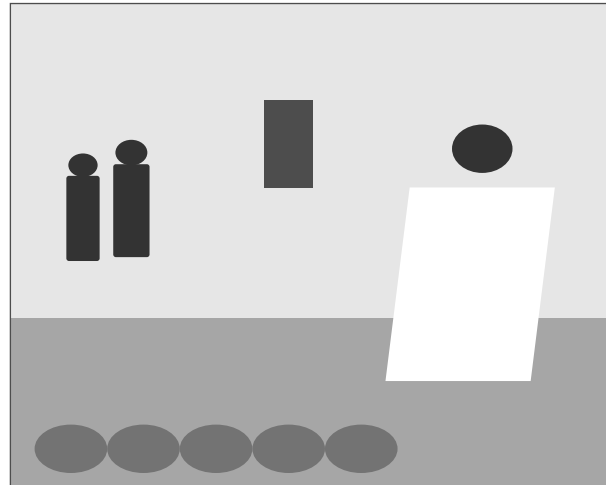


Figure 2.2: **House by a Railroad**, oil, 1925; catalogued as House by the Railroad, 24 x 29 as the leaf writes it (Book I, leaf 52, ref 18056). The Museum of Modern Art, 3.1930: <https://www.moma.org/collection/works/78330>. **The Automat**, oil, 1927, 28 x 36" as the leaf writes it (Book I, leaf 54; Dealers, leaf 56). Des Moines Art Center, 1958.2: <https://desmoinesartcenter.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/04/cc-hopper.pdf>. **Railroad Sunset**, oil, 1929; « A real beauty this one. », 29 x 48 as the leaf writes it (Book I, leaf 58, ref 18297). Whitney Museum of American Art, work 5874: <https://whitney.org/collection/works/5874>. Scale: sixty inches to eight centimetres, the scale of every canvas frame in this note. The drawings are schemas of the composition in its main masses only, at the proportions of the size in Edward Hopper's hand, made from the leaf's description and from general knowledge of the picture; nothing is traced and no detail is drawn, and they are not reproductions. The pictures themselves are at the museums' own pages. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from the transcriptions and works.json (2026-09-13).



Tables for Ladies, 4 x 5 ft.

Figure 2.3: **Tables for Ladies**, oil, 1930, 4 x 5 ft. as the leaf writes it (Book I, leaf 59, ref 16991). The Metropolitan Museum of Art, Hearn Fund, 1931: <https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/487695>. Scale: sixty inches to eight centimetres. The drawings are schemas of the composition in its main masses only, at the proportions of the size in Edward Hopper's hand, made from the leaf's description and from general knowledge of the picture; nothing is traced and no detail is drawn, and they are not reproductions. The pictures themselves are at the museums' own pages. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from the transcriptions and works.json (2026-09-13).

2.4 Her own collection

The signed statement in the bank box points to a thread that runs through all six books and is easy to miss: Josephine Hopper's own collection, and her anxiety that it should be recorded as hers. On leaf 47, under Etching Collections, she lists the impressions she owned: «these Etchings acquired as gifts for Xmas, birthday etc.», dedicated «To my Wife or To Jo», and «Left to show at Rehn Gallery after the Carnegie Inst. Show where they had been framed (& mats trimming off!)». On the Gifts leaf she returns to it: «They have been cut down (!) + framed by the Carnegie.» (Book I, leaf 47, ref 18539; Book I, leaf 99, ref 17911). Book V's loans page records one of her drawings «Owned by Jo N. Hopper for her collection». In the dealers' book she writes of the same set: «All of this original group of 1933 Signed to my wife J.H.H. Should be full set, each given at some anniversary + set completed for Mod. Mus. show» (Dealers, leaf 52, ref 17913). These are the books of a woman who was also a painter, who knew what would happen to a collection nobody had documented, and who used her husband's ledgers to document hers.

The Gifts leaf has one more entry that belongs here because it points across the archive to the notebooks: «Night Shadows - Etching - May 1947 to Carl Hauptman - celebrating The Battle of Wash. Sq.», and another impression to «Owen Grundy - of the Greenwich Villager who promoted the Battle of Wash. Sq.» (Book I, leaf 99, ref 17911). The fight with New York University over the house, which fills two of the four notebooks, was won, or was thought to have been won, in May 1947, and the ledger records the thank-you presents.

2.5 Lists, and the money that vanishes

The Current Exhibitions leaves (84 to 89) and the Reviews, Reproductions and Photographs leaves (90 to 93) hold ten leaves without a dollar sign, except the pound and the five dollars of the British Museum. The One Man Shows leaf gives the career in a column: 1919 Whitney Club; 1924 Rehn watercolours; 1926 St. Botolph's; 1927 and 1929 Rehn; 1932 Cleveland, guest of honour; 1933 Museum of Modern Art; 1934 the Arts Club of Chicago and the Fogg; 1937 Carnegie; 1941 Rehn, «Early Paintings 1907-1914»; 1948 Rehn; 1950 the Whitney retrospective, 13 February to 24 March, then Detroit; 1952 the Venice Biennale, «4 Americans ... E. Hopper, Stuart Davis, Kuniosti, Alex. Calder» (Book I, leaf 49, ref 17717). The Prizes leaves run from the Bryan and Logan prizes of \$25 each for East Side Interior in 1923 to the Corcoran's «1" Prize of 2000 + Corcoran Gold Medal, Mar. 21", 1937 - on Cape Cod Afternoon» and Chicago's «Ada S. Garrett prize \$750» for Night Hawks in 1942 (Book I, leaf 94, ref 17837; Book I, leaf 95, ref 16884).

The Reviews leaf has her reading the critics: «Reference to E.H. all the findings of the abstractionists there in E.H. », of Edward Alden Jewell in the Times; «Forbes Watson speaks of E.H. as the² second best artist writer in America» (Book I, leaf 96, ref 16426). And it records the one fee he earned as a writer: «Review by E. Hopper — for The Arts - Mar. 1926 (Rec'd check for \$13.30, Ap. 7, 26.» (Book I, leaf 98, ref 18065). The money returns on the last leaf, turned ninety degrees, in the accounts of the Rehn show of February 1927: advertising 161.50, window signs 3, photographs 44.80, frames for four oils 64, a frame for Two on the Aisle 20.74, ten watercolours 24.45, one etching 24, total 342.49; and against it the settlement of 4 November, «F. Rehn - 1452.68»: Two on the Aisle 1000, two watercolours 333.34, eight etchings 119.34 (Book I, leaf 100, ref 17174). The costs of the first one-man show at a commercial gallery were a quarter of what it brought in.

The back flyleaf is a chronology of summers, 1923 to 1963, and it is the skeleton of the life the notebooks flesh out: «1924 - near Bass Rocks " married »; «1930 - Visit with Edward W. Root - Hamilton College, Clinton. No painting by E. H. »; «1934 - Built Studio house at S. Truro ... Not so much painting done - except watercolor of Jenness House»; 1941 the Pacific trip; 1943 and 1946 Mexico; 1948 «Rehn show, first hospital stay»; 1950 «diverticulosis»; «1962 - Truck burnt near Beach - Oct. »; 1963 the St. Botolph's award (Book I, flyleaf, ref 17234). The years 1957 to 1959 are not written.

2.6 What is lost, and what is doubtful

A reader should know where Book I cannot be read. The hinged clippings are the chief loss: the Worcester halftone on leaf 2 hides every price from January 1921 to December 1922; leaf 56 is «the most nearly lost leaf»; the Camel's Hump halftone on leaf 81 is pasted flat with no second photograph. The Whitney's photographers turned some clippings back and photographed the leaf again, calling the second image a verso; the edition transcribes each table once, at the sheet where it can be read, and says which. The names that never settle are the buyers': Crowninshield is spelt three ways, Sheaffer three, Spaulding two, Saltillo four. None is corrected, and the reason is the same as for the prices: a corrected name in a ledger is a claim about who bought a picture, and the leaf did not make it.

Only one reading in the entire volume is marked as checked by a person against the photograph: «Chicago», first read «Shicago», on leaf 8. That is the state of the edition, and this study inherits it.

Book II: one picture to an opening

3.1 *The shape of the record*

Book II is a stationer's journal with printed blue leaf numbers at the outer corner and a code, «C-1040 J», at the foot of the cover. Its index, on leaf 1, is in pencil and is arranged not by title but by kind: «Oils p. 2 – 33», «77 – 97 ~~(1939)~~ – 1942.», «French Oils – p. 60 – 63», «Water colors p. 36 – 60.», «Julie photographs - list - p. 99.» (Book II, leaf 1, ref 16974). The volume that results is not chronological. Its front leaves hold the oils of October 1932 to 1942, in painting order; its middle holds the watercolours of 1932 to 1942 two to four to a leaf; and then, at leaf 60, it goes back thirty years, to the nine Paris oils of 1907–09, the early American oils of 1908–14, an inventory of what was left in Nyack, and the checklist of the Rehn show of January 1941, «Edward Hopper 1907–1914», annotated over fifteen years. The book was begun in 1932, when the household moved from the rear studio to the front one at 3 Washington Square North, and the earlier work was written into it later, from memory and from the older books.

A leaf has the shape already described: the title and size in his hand; the record drawing, ruled into a box; the paint line; her description; the sale. The block migrates down the leaf as the years pass, and the transcription's advice is to read the head of each leaf rather than to assume. What does not migrate is the sale sentence, and it is worth quoting one entire because it is the atom of the whole archive: «May 13, 42 Chicago Art Institute - 3000 + return of Compartment C. 1000 - Com. 1/3 = 2000», and below it, «Oct. 27, 42 Ada S. Garret Prize \$750» (Book II, leaf 95, ref 17982). That is the sale of Nighthawks. The picture cost three thousand dollars and a smaller canvas the museum had bought four years earlier and now handed back; the gallery took a third; the painter received two thousand, and five months later a prize.

3.2 *The descriptions*

What makes Book II unlike any other artist's ledger I know is the paragraph under the drawing. It begins, on the first leaves, as a note of light and colour, and it acquires almost at once the habit of naming the people in the picture and telling what they are doing. On the earliest leaves the voice is that of a painter looking at a landscape:

Late afternoon until dark, hills + house in silhouette against blue greeny sky with long strip of white clouds. Late Sept., tall grasses changing colors - pink in light. Hills roll for dear life! Field of tall grass in foregr. Entirely in light. Glorious! (Mrs. Scott's House, Book II, leaf 2, ref 17332)

Dauphinée House, on the same leaf: «Painted late in afternoon thru many changes of light til too dark to see. Peaceful before dark. House closed up + for sale. Built by a Capt.

Kelly. » East Wind over Weehawken, with the painter in it: « Such cold raw weather, E. H. going over to Jersey to make sketches, could have caught pneumonia, but would go.. » (Book II, leaf 5, ref 17555). Shakespeare at Dusk: « Mall, Central Park about 5 P.M. Nov. dusk with pink glow in sky back of trees. Foreground grey pavement, slightly warmed by glow in sky overhead (off stage). » and, at the end, a painter's self-criticism that is certainly not his: « Red, Electric sign showing thru foliage not well explained. » (Book II, leaf 9, ref 18112).

« Off stage » is her phrase and it recurs. She had been an actress with the Washington Square Players before she was his wife, and the pictures are described as scenes: what is lit from where, who stands where, what is happening beyond the edge. The Long Leg: « Boat white sailing into the wind. (Sun rear left off stage), light touching obliquely L. edges of sails, otherwise in shadow. Sails very taut, hard as marble in stiff breeze. » (Book II, leaf 11, ref 17478). The Sheridan Theatre: « Girl in bright red skirt, white jacket, dark fur collar, black hat + yellow curly hair (Mae West effect) » (Book II, leaf 19, ref 17977). New York Movie, which the leaf calls N.Y. Movie House, gets a lighting plot:

usher has yellow hair + flesh colored feet in black sandals. Dark blue uniform. Pewter grey + dull white on screen (snowy mountain tips) ... Light from 4 sources: bracket with 3 lights, right wall, light inside stair case R. light from lamps under side of boxes, L. + light from screen. ... Much darker than this sketch. Brightest point, girl's hair + glint on brass rail. ... Face resting on hand, hand light. L. hand holds end of flash light. (Book II, leaf 27, ref 16621)

« Much darker than this sketch »: the description corrects the drawing, hers correcting his, and the correction is about the one thing the drawing cannot carry, which is tone.

Then the anecdotes. Office at Night: « "Confidentatly Yours". Room 1005. » and « Man in grey coat, blond hair. "Shirley" in blue dress, white collar, flesh stockings [*illegible*] pumps + black hair + plenty of lip stick. Figures stand out in space, not fastened to background. » (Book II, leaf 79, ref 16494). The Provincetown diary supplies the other half of that entry: on 22 February 1940 they took the canvas up to Rehn's, where there were « Attempts at christening; John Clancy suggesting: Cordially yours; Room 1566 ». The title in the ledger, then, is a rejected joke of the dealer's, kept by her in quotation marks, and « Shirley » is a name she gave the secretary. Cape Cod Evening has a footnote: « * Was to have been called "Whippoorwill." Dog hears it. Woman a Finn + dour. Trees in phalanx plantation, creeping up on one the dark. The whippoorwill in there out of sight. » and, further down, « Painted in S. Truro studio. Dog sat in poor Zerty's' car parked at Truro PO. » (Book II, leaf 31, ref 16755). Gas: « Late twilight. Hanging sign "Mobiloil" + red horse lit from above, red pumps (3) with lamps lit ... Blond man in blue pants, white shirt, black vest tending pump - (son of Capt. Ed Staples burnt in train wreck returning from Cleveland Mus. show) ... (Notice light on sign, hauntingly familiar) » (Book II, leaf 83, ref 18432). The attendant, who has no face to speak of, is given a father, and the father is the sitter of an earlier picture, and that picture burnt in a railway accident recorded in Book I. The record books are a closed world and everything in them refers to everything else.

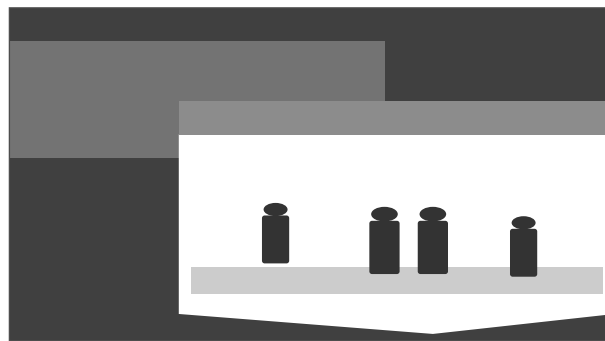
And Nighthawks, which she writes as two words:

Night + brilliant interior of cheap restaurant. Bright items; cheery wood counter + tops of surrounding stools; lights on metal tanks at rear right; brilliant streak of jade green tiles 3/4 across canvas - at base of glass of window. ... Very good looking blond

boy in white (coat, cap) inside counter. Girl in red blouse, brown hair eating sandwich.
Man night hawk (beek) in dark suit, steel grey hat, black band, blue shirt (clean)
holding cigarette. Other figure dark sinister back - at left. ... Sign across top of shop
dark - Phillies 5¢ Cigar, picture of cigar. (Book II, leaf 95, ref 17982)

«Man night hawk (beek)»: the title is explained as a nose. Nobody who has written about the picture since has had a better authority for what it was called and why, and the authority is a parenthesis in a ledger.

The transcription notices that the genre shifts. From leaf 45 the description «has stopped being an anecdote about who is in the picture and become a note of what color everything is»; on leaf 51 there is no description at all. The anecdotes belong to the oils of the 1930s and early 1940s, and to the figures in them; the watercolours of the Cape, which have no figures, get colour notes or nothing. Whatever the descriptions are, they are not a programme. They are what she thought worth saying about a picture on the day it left the studio, and on the days when the picture had people in it she gave the people names.



Night Hawks, 33 x 60

Figure 3.1: **Night Hawks**, oil, finished 21 January 1942; catalogued as Nighthawks, 33 x 60 as the leaf writes it (Book II, leaf 95, ref 17982). Art Institute of Chicago, 1942.51: <https://www.artic.edu/artworks/111628>. Scale: sixty inches to eight centimetres. The drawings are schemas of the composition in its main masses only, at the proportions of the size in Edward Hopper's hand, made from the leaf's description and from general knowledge of the picture; nothing is traced and no detail is drawn, and they are not reproductions. The pictures themselves are at the museums' own pages. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from the transcriptions and works.json (2026-09-13).

3.3 Herself

She is in the book as model, as painter and as owner. Jo Painting (Book II, leaf 13, ref 16839), a portrait of her, gets a description in the third person that is plainly a self-portrait in words: «Head against light. warm flesh tones against white background (painted on white canvas. greyish Blue wool dress with whitish crash collar, silver brooch with green stone centre. Hair darkish brown + very bushy, just having been washed + waiting to dry thoroughly.» Its sale line reads «Given to wife, Jo N. Hopper as anniversary present | 1955». Compartment C, Car 293: «A green picture (veridian + Cadmium deep) - green slightly olive. ... Girl with gold hair, flesh colored legs dressed in my purple wool jersey dress + black hat. ... On seat Reader's Digest in purple cover.» (Book II, leaf 25, ref

18545). The transcriber's note is exact: «the dress she puts on the girl is her own». The Provincetown diary confirms that she posed, «by night light in big pokey hat & hair down», in March 1938, and again for Office at Night, «in a light skirt», in February 1940. The women in the pictures of these years are Josephine Hopper in her own clothes, and the ledger says so in passing.

Her opinions are in it too. Cape Cod Afternoon, which won the Corcoran's first prize and two thousand dollars in 1937: «Looked good for nothing in dark Carnegie room, but glorious at Whitney Retrospective on W. 8th St.» (Book II, leaf 17, ref 16656); and on the same leaf, that the second prize went «to Guy Pène du Bois», and that both winners were «dwellers of 3 Wash. Sq. N.» Blackwell's Island, sold to Russell Allen in 1929, gets a later pencil: «This a beautiful canvas but Russel Allen gone for the abstract in Boston so got rid of this canvas to son-in-law or nephew» (Book II, leaf 35, ref 16536). The politics of the house are on the watercolour leaves: «Returned to N.Y. early to go to Pittsburgh - jury» and «to register, then back from Cape early to N.Y.C. to vote against Roosevelt» (Book II, leaf 55, ref 17435); «Oct. 9, 40 brought back to N.Y. on hasty trip home to register for Willkie» (Book II, leaf 83, ref 18432). The year of the hurricane: «Watercolors - South Truro - 1933. Rained all summer.» (Book II, leaf 39, ref 17049); «1934 - The year we built the house, not much painting done.» (Book II, leaf 42, ref 17766).

3.4 *Paint*

Under nearly every oil, in the same words for thirty years, stands the formula. On the leaves of 1932 to 1936 it is «Zinc white, Rembrandt colors, poppy oil»; in 1937–38, «Belgian canvas, Rembrandt colors, lead white, linseed oil»; from 1939 the colourman changes to Winsor & Newton, with Blockx beside it, and the whites and the oils begin to vary. The fullest is under The MacArthurs' Home, the portrait of Helen Hayes's house that the Provincetown diary says he «hates the imposed job» of painting: «Belgian smooth, double prime canvas, Blockx and Winsor & Newton colors. poppy oil, Blockx Silver (lead) White. Sky of cerulean blue (Blockx) / 1 1/2 month painting.» (Book II, leaf 77, ref 17681). Nighthawks: «Blockx and Winsor & Newton colors, W & N. Zinc white, poppy oil. English linen, domestic priming.» She dates the Paris canvases by the paint: «Probably 1909 because white paint not altered. 1907 cheaper paint» (Book II, leaf 61, ref 16607). The change of colourman is dated to the week by the diary: on 18 May 1938, «E. wants to change over to Windsor Newton oils — So I'm to inherit gold Rembrandt colors.» The Technique chapter takes this up; here it is enough to note that the formula is the one part of the leaf that is neither a measurement nor a report of an event, but her hand recording his practice.

3.5 *The money, and what came back*

The prices in Book II run from nine hundred dollars to eleven thousand. Cape Cod Afternoon went to the Carnegie for 3000 in 1938; New York Movie to Stephen Clark for 2500 in 1939; Gas to the Museum of Modern Art for 1800 in 1943; the Sheridan Theatre to Newark for 900 in 1940; Sun on Prospect Street to Edward G. Robinson, «someone in movie world named Robinson» as the diary has it, for 1000 the same year. The pictures that stayed

longest sold highest: Dauphinée House, painted in October 1932, went to Huntington Hartford for 5000 in June 1956; Men, Women and Horses, of April 1939, to Leistner for 4500 in 1958; and Girlie Show, of April 1941, to Charles Stein in July 1961 for 11,000, «the highest price in Book II» as the transcriber notes (Book II, leaf 89, ref 16635). A canvas of 1913, Corner Saloon, was bought by the Museum of Modern Art out of the show of early work in January 1941, part paid in cash and part with «2 old water colors / given some years before by Mrs. John D. Rockefeller, Jr.» (Book II, leaf 87, ref 18258). Sailing, the first canvas sold, «Turned up + brought to Rehn Gal. ± 1951 + resold for \$1200. for owner» (Book II, leaf 68, ref 16468).

Museums took a discount over the dealer's third and the book records each: «Mus. discount 12%» on East Wind over Weehawken to the Pennsylvania Academy; «10% off of 2500» for Cape Cod Evening to the Encyclopaedia Britannica. The Whitney's purchase of the Circle Theatre for 1800 in 1936 was undone in 1950, when the museum returned it «for \$500 ... in exchange for 7 A.M.», and the leaf follows the canvas to Stein at 2500 in 1951 (Book II, leaf 14 verso; Book II, leaf 15, ref 18268). Pictures came back: Capron House and Longnook Valley «Returned to Studio Nov. 12, '36»; Compartment C from Chicago in 1942, «Frame changed again. Art Inst. frame no good. They had changed original frame.» Pictures were given: Cape Cod Sunset and two Paris oils to her; Shacks at Pamet Head to Lloyd Goodrich; Route 14, Vermont to a Finnish relief auction; Dawn Before Gettysburg «presented to Arthuro Grassi! taken off to Italy», with the dealer's assistant carrying the canvas down to the purser «after boat sailed» (Book II, leaf 4, ref 18397).

And there is the dealer's death. House at Dusk went to the Virginia Museum in 1953, and the leaf records what happened to the money: «Payment held up by illness of Frank Rehn beginning Sept. 53. Paid by Va. Mus. Early 1953. Death of Frank Rehn - Mar. 1956 - no provision in his will for payment of this sum.» (Book II, leaf 6, ref 17606). The date of Rehn's death is wrong here and wrong differently on the title page of Book III, and the transcription corrects neither; what the sentence records is that a museum's cheque, passed through a dying dealer's gallery, did not reach the painter until June 1956, and that the widow of the painter wrote it down.

3.6 Arithmetic

Five rows in the whole archive fail the check that the receipt equals the price less the commission, and two are in Book II: 2550 less a third written as 1660 on leaf 45, and 1250 less a third written as 850 on leaf 85 against 1275 to 850 on leaf 81, both cheques dated 29 December 1947. The transcription reports the disagreement and does not resolve it. Ninety of ninety-five checkable rows agree to the cent, which is a better rate than most published accounts of artists' incomes can claim, and it is the strongest evidence in the archive that the record was kept from the cheque and not from memory.

Book III: the late work, and the lists in front of it

4.1 A book with its lists at the front

Book III is the last of the work books and the one that runs to the painter's death. It has a printed alphabetical thumb index cut into its fore-edge, and she used the tabs to file the lists: Prizes under «G H», Reproductions under «M Mc», Gifts under «V», Whereabouts under «C D», each with the Book I page number beside it because each list continues one begun there (index, ref 18022). Nineteen unnumbered sheets of these lists stand in front of the work book; then the oils on the odd leaves from 1 to 89, Hotel Lobby to The Two Comedians; then the watercolours from Mexico, Wyoming and the Cape on leaves 101 to 125; and at the back two more Whereabouts leaves, a Frames memorandum and five leaves of Memoranda, which are continuous prose and the densest writing in the volume.

The title page announces the dealer, and gets his death wrong: «Frank K. M. Rehn sole dealer since Oct. 1924. The Rehn Gallery 683 - 5th Ave. N.Y.C. In summer of 1960, moved to 36 East 61st St. John J. Chaney⁷ succeeding Frank K. M. Rehn as Sole director, Since 1953. Frank K. M. Rehn died in 1958 thru stroke & long illness since summer 1953.» (title, ref 16528). The Memoranda leaf at the back has him «stricken Early Sept. 1953» and «Died there Early in 1956», and Book II has March 1956. The 8 on the title page is written over another figure. She corrected the record, but not everywhere, and the edition lets each leaf say what it says.

4.2 The pictures, and what she said they were

The descriptive habit of Book II continues, and it changes. There are still colour plots: Hotel Lobby, «Girl beautiful blond, dull blue dress, flesh colored stockings. Older woman, white hair, coral silk dress, black coat + hat.» (Book III, leaf 1, ref 16279); Summer Time, «Big strong girl in thin white dress, flesh showing thru of right upper leg. ... Otherwise entire absence of local color as such.» (Book III, leaf 3, ref 17456). There are still names: Deborah and Sammy in Conference at Night («Deborah is blond, a queen in her own right. ... Sammy better looking than here in drawing.», Book III, leaf 29, ref 17590); Sheila and Adam in Sea Watchers («Irish girl, gentle, sweet, large - Yankee clam digger - very fine people - on New England coast for late swim. Inventions of E.H.», Book III, leaf 47, ref 18177); Dinah in South Carolina Morning; Toots in Second Story Sunlight, «good Toots, alert but not obstreperous. lamb in wolf's clothing», with the marginal «the painter quoted» (Book III, leaf 73, ref 17872); Nora in Intermission, «E. H. says she is

“Nora”. ... E. says Nora is on the way of becoming an “egg head”! An efficient secretary or prized chatelaine of big house.» (Book III, leaf 81, ref 17386). «Inventions of E.H.», «the painter quoted», «E. H. says»: here, for once, the names are attributed to him, and it is worth noticing that she takes the trouble to say so, as if she knew that a reader might assume they were hers.

But the descriptions in Book III are shorter, and they are more willing to say what a picture is *about*. Summer Evening, entire: «She standing out for matrimony.» (Book III, leaf 25, ref 18128). Sun in an Empty Room, entire: «green bushes outside window. White light + uncompromising shadows. Stark.» (Book III, leaf 83, ref 17402). Hotel by a Railroad: «Emphasis on mood. Wife bitterly watches husband + tracks below window.» (Book III, leaf 45, ref 17302), which the transcriber rightly calls the only place in its batch where she says what a picture is about rather than what colour it is. Two Puritans: «2 white houses (dull Oct. day) loom like white petunias. Wan whiteish sky.» and «The halo of a pale blond beauty about this one. In class with Solitude, Rooms by the Sea, Moonlight Interior.» (Book III, leaf 15, ref 16329). October on Cape Cod carries the nearest thing in the archive to a statement of the painter’s mind, and she marks it off the record: «“Peace, quiet, no birds sing.” “Some day you will be quiet too” - E. H.’s favorite Goethe. (strictly off the record)» (Book III, leaf 19, ref 16838).

Rooms by the Sea has an alias in its title line, «Alias “The Jumping Off Place”», and a defence: «Inside contrasts not planned for intentional dramatic effect but as observed in a room full of light on Cape Cod ... Nothing of the palatial tourist camp. “Jumping Off Place” for name, turned down - but moonlight overtones ascribed by some.» (Book III, leaf 41, ref 18347). Hotel Window, of 1955, answers a critic nobody has named: «What ever interests woman gazing out must occur off stage at left of canvas ... Picture definitely not called: “Alone in the City at night.” But why not?» (Book III, leaf 55, ref 16671). Sunlight in a Cafeteria: «Sunlight + Space the whole story, the 2 figures quite negated by light on walls of large forms used. ... She a voluptuous blond. ... “Eating not interested in Color!”» and, of the buyer, «He saw this canvas in studio, having climbed up the 74 steps of 3 Washington Square North for that purpose.» (Book III, leaf 65, ref 17966). Excursion into Philosophy: «Real Hopper landscape out of window: A.M. Sun in blue sky touching green dune tops ... the open book is Plato, reread too late. ... Painted in 11 days. Aug 15” - 26”, 1959.» (Book III, leaf 69, ref 18472). «Real Hopper landscape»: she has begun to write about him as a public figure, and a picture is now a Hopper.

Her verdicts on frames, hangings and museums sharpen with age. A Woman in the Sun: «Tragic figure of small woman, blond, straight brown hair, grabs cigarette before shimmy shirt. ... Cigarette + sad face of woman unlit. (Bad frame; insert same color as window curtain R., takes all force out of highest spot in canvas» and «Skin craving the warm therapy of this Early light. Ett called her “a wise tramp!” The humanity of the producers of the play “Diary of Anne Frank”, took her in, not to art market.» (Book III, leaf 75, ref 17107). Under the title, in a hand the edition cannot identify, «“the WISE TRAMP”». The producers of the play are the Hacketts, Albert Hackett and Frances Goodrich, Lloyd Goodrich’s sister, who had bought French Six Day Rider in 1937; the last words in the volume, on the fifth Memoranda leaf, are about her: «the sight of Lady in the Sun owned by Frances Hackett in the one + only perfect frame. Secured by Frances H., the only perfect frame ever worn by a Hopper canvas.» (Book III, leaf 194, ref 17259).

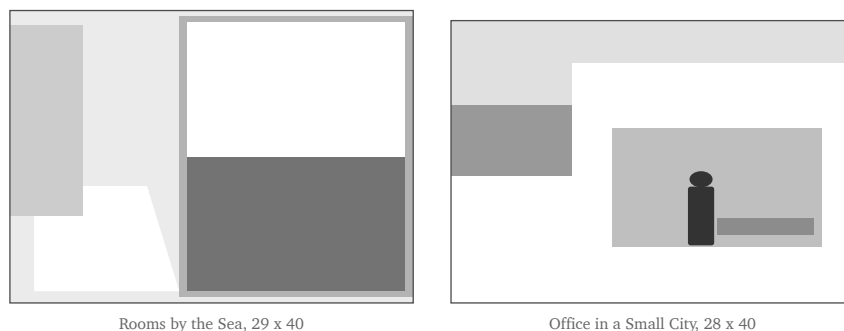


Figure 4.1: **Rooms by the Sea**, oil, September 1951; alias « The Jumping Off Place », 29 x 40 as the leaf writes it (Book III, leaf 41, ref 18347). Yale University Art Gallery, 1961.18.29: <https://lux.collections.yale.edu/view/object/63bdda22-a6be-413d-9a35-5e2649c14c21>. **Office in a Small City**, oil, September 1953, 28 x 40 as the leaf writes it (Book III, leaf 49, ref 18028). The Metropolitan Museum of Art, 53.183: <https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/488730>. Scale: sixty inches to eight centimetres; the two 28-by-40 and 29-by-40 formats of the studio pictures of 1949 to 1954. The drawings are schemas of the composition in its main masses only, at the proportions of the size in Edward Hopper's hand, made from the leaf's description and from general knowledge of the picture; nothing is traced and no detail is drawn, and they are not reproductions. The pictures themselves are at the museums' own pages. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from the transcriptions and works.json (2026-09-13).

4.3 The buyers

Book III names a buyer on every leaf, which Book IV, as we shall see, only begins to do in 1954. Stephen Clark is the collector of the volume: Rooms for Tourists in 1946, «Now owned by Griswold of Yale»; Rooms by the Sea in 1952, «snapped up at once before shown publicly»; Western Motel in 1958; Sunlight in a Cafeteria in 1958 at 9000; four Mexican and Wyoming watercolours besides. And then the note in pencil at the foot of Excursion into Philosophy:

On hearing about this canvas, Stephen Clark had come to see it. At old 5" Ave. address, he learned of gallery moving to E. 64" St., but when he got there, gallery locked, no one there. He wrote to tell us of his disappointment, but died a short time after that. It should have been his picture. (Book III, leaf 69, ref 18472)

Joseph Hirshhorn bought First Row Orchestra and 11 A.M. together for 5500 in September 1954, Hotel by a Railroad the same month and City Sunlight the year after; Lawrence Fleischman bought New York Office at 16,500 in January 1963 and «passed to Jos. Butler in exchange for an Eakins»; Howard Mack bought Intermission at 25,000; the Detroit museum Sun in an Empty Room at 25,000; the Whitney, through Lloyd Goodrich, Second Story Sunlight at 15,000 «less museum's 1/6» and the gallery's third, so that of fifteen thousand dollars the painter received 8333.34, in two cheques thirteen months apart. Museums appear as buyers and as juries: «During Retrospective at Whitney. Metrop. turned down this canvas for purchase.» (Conference at Night, Book III, leaf 29, ref 17590); «Note from Met to tell E. his Conference at Night has passed both juries» says the diary of November 1950, and Wichita bought it in 1952. The verso facing Morning in a City preserves a collector's doubt: «Stephen Clark wagging his head, predicted "You'll have a hard time disposing of this one."» (ref 16404). It went to Lawrence Bloedel in 1955 for 6000, the highest price in the book to that date.

One sale went wrong, and the book follows it for eight years. Solitude, of 1944, was «Sold 1953 - Septm 4500 - to be paid weekly installments of 500. Chambers'? Caught up on litigation* ... Paid 500 down. ... Who has the picture? No news. Feb. 1958 + no further payments - than first 500.» The asterisk: «Caused by death of Frank Rehn + previous long illness». And the end: «Rec'd July 3, 1961 - Acquired by lawyer Zacker who retained 2000 for him self. Stanley Wolf now owns, has paid up all charges» (Book III, leaf 9, ref 17356). The same passage records that «“Moonlight Interior” badly damaged found in an auction.» The dealer's illness of 1953 to 1956 runs under this volume like a fault line: payments «caught up in Rehn Estate», October on Cape Cod paid only in June 1956 «by John Clancy, new head of Rehn Gallery».

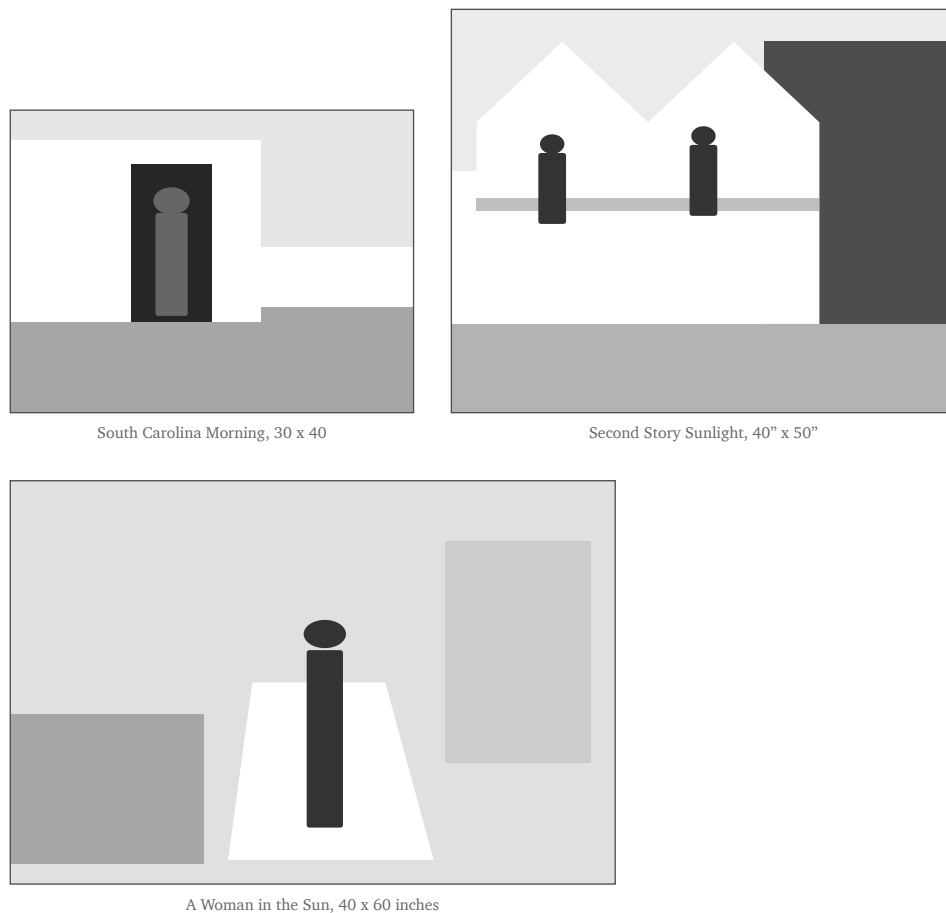


Figure 4.2: **South Carolina Morning**, oil, 1955; «Dinah», 30 x 40 as the leaf writes it (Book III, leaf 53, ref 18558). Whitney Museum of American Art, 67.13: <https://whitney.org/collection/works/789>. **Second Story Sunlight**, oil, 25 August to 15 September 1960; «Toots», 40" x 50" as the leaf writes it (Book III, leaf 73, ref 17872). Whitney Museum of American Art, 60.54: <https://whitney.org/collection/works/873>. **A Woman in the Sun**, oil, October 1961; «the WISE TRAMP», 40 x 60 inches as the leaf writes it (Book III, leaf 75, ref 17107). Whitney Museum of American Art, 84.31: <https://whitney.org/collection/works/1337>. Scale: sixty inches to eight centimetres; the three formats of the last decade, 30 by 40, 40 by 50 and 40 by 60. The drawings are schemas of the composition in its main masses only, at the proportions of the size in Edward Hopper's hand, made from the leaf's description and from general knowledge of the picture; nothing is traced and no detail is drawn, and they are not reproductions. The pictures themselves are at the museums' own pages. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from the transcriptions and works.json (2026-09-13).

4.4 The prices

The sale sentence is the same as Book II's, and the sequence it yields is the clearest statement of what happened to the market for Hopper's work in the last twenty years of his life. Hotel Lobby, 1943: 2500. Summer in the City, 1949: 1200, the lowest oil price in the book, to Lynn Farnol. High Noon and Conference at Night, 1951–52: 3000. Rooms by the Sea, 1952: 4000. Morning Sun, Hotel by a Railroad, First Row Orchestra, 1954: 3500. Sea Watchers, 1956: 4500. Hotel Window, 1957: 7000. Sunlight in a Cafeteria, 1958: 9000. November, Washington Square, 1960: 10,000. Excursion into Philosophy, 1962: 14,500. People in the Sun, 1962: 15,000. New York Office, 1963: 16,500. Sun in an Empty Room, 1964, and Intermission, 1966: 25,000. Chair Car, 1966: 27,000, paid in two instalments and never written in full. The painter's share was two thirds of each, and the last picture of all, The Two Comedians, «Finished Nov. 10», 1966 in S. Truro studio», has no buyer and no price (Book III, leaf 89, ref 16659).

The Memoranda leaves put the figures in a context she found bitter. «Light at 2 Lights sent with Exhib. of Amer. paintings to Russia, Summer 1959. On its return was sold for Richard Tucker by Lloyd Goodrich of the Whitney then to Laurence Fleishman, Collectors, for 25 000, top price for Amer. painting + nearly 25 times the amt. rec'd by the painter from his mother who bought it in 1929.» (Book III, leaf 191, ref 16408). The arithmetic in that sentence is hers, and it is the only resale price in the volume. The watercolours went the same way at a lower level: 600 and 750 in the 1940s, 900 in 1955, 1500 in 1960 and 1962, 1800 for Cliffs near Mitla in 1959, and 6500 for Charleston Slum, a sheet of 1929, in December 1964.

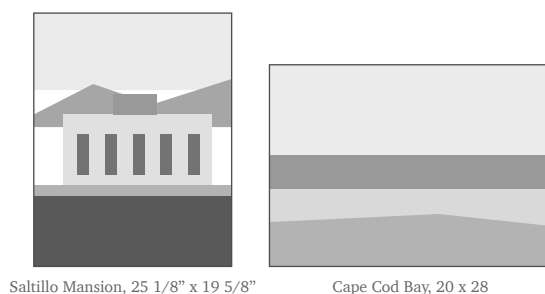


Figure 4.3: **Saltillo Mansion**, watercolour, August 1943, 25 1/8" x 19 5/8" as the leaf writes it (Book III, leaf 101, ref 17944). The Metropolitan Museum of Art, 45.157.2: <https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/488165>. **Cape Cod Bay**, watercolour, 1965; the last work leaf photographed, 20 x 28 as the leaf writes it (Book III, leaf 125, ref 16620). Whitney Museum of American Art, work 6829: <https://whitney.org/collection/works/6829>. Scale: sixty inches to eight centimetres; an upright Mexican sheet of 1943 beside a Cape watercolour of 1965 on the full imperial sheet. The drawings are schemas of the composition in its main masses only, at the proportions of the size in Edward Hopper's hand, made from the leaf's description and from general knowledge of the picture; nothing is traced and no detail is drawn, and they are not reproductions. The pictures themselves are at the museums' own pages. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from the transcriptions and works.json (2026-09-13).

4.5 *Paint again*

The formula continues under nearly every oil, and Book III is where it can be followed year by year. Hotel Lobby, 1943: «W. + N. lead white. Blockx & W. + N. Colors, linseed oil, turpentine. Winton canvas.» Morning in a City, 1944: «W. + N. flake white # 1 + 2. Blockx + W. + N. colors. Tarr, Ruhl linseed oil + turpentine. Grumbacher's paint tested artists' canvas (linen).» The Martha McKeen: «Started with Tarr Ruhl linseed oil, finished with poppy oil». From High Noon in 1949 to South Carolina Morning in 1955 the line is fixed: «Winsor & Newton (National) double prime canvas and W & N. colors, flake white, linseed oil and turpentine», with Chremnitz white replacing flake from Morning Sun in 1952. From Sunlight on Brownstones in 1956 the canvas becomes «Herga», single prime, and the transcription notices that «single» is struck out on four leaves and left on four others, and that «Nothing on any leaf says why». The last formula, under The Two Comedians, is also the most explanatory: «W. + N. Herger Canvas, single white prime linen canvas + smoother as double would be, but less apt to crack than double. W. + N. lead white + Colors. Linseed oil with turpentine». On High Noon a paler pencil adds: «E.H. made little model of house out of heavy white paper to observe how light would fall on corners of house.» (Book III, leaf 31, ref 16818). The diary of 31 August 1950 saw the «paper model for High Noon» on the desk.

4.6 *The end of the record*

The last picture leaf is dated 10 November 1966. The last money is Chair Car's balance on 16 December 1966, with «1967» in an unresolved line at the foot. The last date in the whole volume is «1967 Death of Arnold Slade of Truro» on a Memoranda leaf. Nothing in Josephine Hopper's hand records Edward Hopper's death on 15 May 1967, in any of the six books. The record was kept, as the inside cover of Book I said, «at time each work is finished, or before it leaves studio», and when the work stopped so did the record.

The Memoranda also hold her account of the retrospective of 1950: «Hopper Retrospective in Boston - Canvases hung so closely frames nearly touched ... Very bad showing for oils.» and «At the Whitney, N.Y. - Everything glowed against beautiful walls» (Book III, leaf 190, ref 17739); of *Reality*, «the first united squawk from the Realist painters against the usurpation of the Non objective people at the Mod. Mus., Whitney + many museums throughout the Country»; of the Time cover story of 1956, in the Reviews list, «E. Hopper Cover Story - (fraudulent + insulting)» (ref 17715); and of the Gold Medal of the Institute of Arts and Letters in 1955, in the Whereabouts: «Acceptance by E. H. not read by E. H. who only said "Thanks" until Henry P. shook him stoutly by shoulders + said "Say it again!"» (ref 17581). The Whereabouts leaf for 1960 records the house at last heated: «At 3 Wash. Sq. chaos with arrival of Hitler's aggressors, utter chaos, five studios turned into offices for Social Service Dept. But Radiators arrive for 1960 Xmas. So needn't go to Mexico to escape cold.» and «the enforced intimacy with almost affection + appreciation, an experience shared + the great reward: radiators» (Book III, leaf 170, ref 18199). Thirteen years after the Battle of Washington Square, the university that had tried to turn them out put in the heating.

Book IV: the pocket book, fifty-four years without a gap

5.1 *An object unlike the others*

Book IV came to the Whitney folded inside a used envelope, typewritten «EDWARD HOPPER / 3 WASHINGTON SQUARE N. / NEW YORK CITY, NEW YORK» and metered at Lynbrook in July 1963 (ref 16225). It is a stationer's pocket memorandum book, «MEMORANDUM» stamped on brown cloth, seven and a half inches by four and three-quarters, its pages ruled into a date column, a description column and a money column divided into dollars and cents by two printed red rules. Nobody adds a column and nobody heads one. It begins on 15 November 1913 and ends on 23 March 1967, and between those dates there is no gap. It is the only one of the six volumes that the Whitney dated leaf by leaf, and it is, for that reason, the volume the edition's timeline can point into.

It is also in a hand the edition does not name. The first batch describes «a fluent sloping copperplate» unlike either hand recorded from the work books, and every passage in all fourteen batches is attributed to nobody. The entries begin eleven years before Josephine Nivison joined the household. Whether the hand of 1913 and the hand of 1967 are the same, and whether either is Edward Hopper's, is a question the transcription puts and does not answer. What it can say is how the book was kept, because the book has a method and the method is written in colour.

5.2 *Charges black, receipts red, sums pencil*

On leaves 3 to 6 the text is black and the money figures are red. From leaf 7, in May 1914, the colours swap and hold for fifty-three years: the charge in black, the receipt line in red, «Rec'd by check» and its figure written across the whole width of the leaf; and, from leaf 66, a pencil sum at the foot of the leaf, and from leaf 114 a labelled total for the year. The edition records the ink where it has been read off the photographs, and where it has, «red money is a receipt and pencil money a sum before any word is read». This is not a detail of the transcription; it is the accounting system, and a black-and-white reproduction of Book IV would not be a reproduction of it.

The first entry is the model for the first decade:

1913	Nov. 15th	Asc. Sunday Magazines / 2 line drawings / "The Iron Stickpin"
20 00	/ "Wayland"	20 00 / Nov. 22nd Rec'd by check \$40 00 (Book IV, leaf 3, ref 17106)

A client, its items one to a line with their prices, and the cheque a week later. Twenty dollars a line drawing for the Associated Sunday Magazines is the baseline of the volume, and the illustration years are a catalogue of what a commercial artist in New York was paid between 1913 and 1925. The clients are named in full: U.S. Printing and Litho for Eclair film posters at ten and twelve dollars a sheet, with «Time watching films 2»; the A. W. Shaw Company, half tones at twenty-five a half page; J. Walter Thompson, «Enos Salts» for twenty; Everybody's Magazine, four war drawings, «1 Uhlans charging 25 / 1 Infantry attack 25 / 1 German gun in action 40 / 1 French in trenches 25»; Webb Publishing of St Paul, twenty a drawing; the Wells Fargo Messenger, «1 wagon poster 50»; Adventure, the long lists at fifteen a drawing, fifteen drawings for \$225 with titles like «The Man-Breaker», «Snuffy and the Monster», «The Snagdangle Twins' Last Cleanup»; the Country Gentleman; the Morse Dry Dock Dial, its cover nearly every month from January 1918 at thirty-five, forty, forty-five and fifty dollars, the subjects «painter», «man at lathe», «welder», «boiler maker»; Scribner's, a steady \$175 for three drawings from 1922 to 1925; and the Hotel Management cover, sixty-five a month, from June 1924. In the middle of the war sits the largest sum of the first forty leaves, and it has no charge line: «U. S. Shipping Board / 1 poster / Smash the Hun / rec'd by check 300» (Book IV, leaf 35, ref 18332). The prize was three hundred dollars, and the book, which had no way to write a receipt without a charge, wrote it anyway.

Two other kinds of income sit among the drawings. «Mrs L. Whitins / instruction 7 weeks 105»: he taught, at fifteen dollars a week (Book IV, leaf 67). And the New Republic paid «plate Night Shadows 100» and «Robert Hallowell / advance royalties 100» for the portfolio of 1924 (Book IV, leaf 71, ref 17582). The last illustration money is a Hotel Management cover billed on 3 December 1925 and paid on Christmas Eve (Book IV, leaf 77, ref 16585). The transcription's own header says November; the leaf says December; the difference is one cover, and it is the kind of thing a second reader is for.

5.3 The pictures arrive

The first painting in the book is two lines, out of date order: «Nov 16 Bklyn Museum / The Mansarde Roof 100 / Dec 14 rec'd by check 100» (Book IV, leaf 66, ref 17008), in 1923. The first etching sold is on leaf 49, in 1920, to the Print Makers of Los Angeles: «The Monhegan Boat. / @ \$18. less 10% 16 20», the first use of the cents column. The prizes of 1923 are written as purchases: «Chicago Society of Etchers / prize award the Logan / 1 East Side Interior 25». The Metropolitan's fifteen prints at ten dollars are on leaf 75, in May 1925. The British Museum paid «£1 / rec'd by cash £1» with a pencilled «5 00» beneath, the only sterling in the book (Book IV, leaf 80, ref 16737).

And then, on leaf 71, 24 November 1924: «Frank K. M. Rehn / 5 Water colors at 33 1/3 % / 1 100 / 2 100 / 3 100 / 4 100 / 5 100 / » 24 rec'd by check 500». The watercolours are unnamed and numbered down the column; the hundred is the net; the series runs to fourteen by January 1925. Rehn had sold the Gloucester watercolours off the walls of his back room, and the pocket book records the money without recording the pictures. From the end of 1925 the works are named: «3 Water colors / the Locomotive of D & G. 133 34 / Adobe Houses 133 34 / La Penitente 133 34 / rec'd 400» (Book IV, leaf 77, ref 16585). The illustration stops the same month. The two trades, which the work books never mention

together, hand over to one another on one leaf.

5.4 Four ways of writing a commission

The edition's method note for Book IV divides the volume into four periods by how the commission is written, and the division is the best account we have of how a dealer's statement looked to the person who received it. In 1924–27 the rate is written, «at 33 1/3 %». In 1927–30 no rate is written at all, only nets whose cents carry the third: 166.67 for a watercolour, 16.67 for a print. In 1931–37 the deductions are named cash sums, «less \$49.93», «less .50 for mats», «less photo \$16.», which is the photographer's bill passed through and not the dealer's rate; the Whitney's purchase of Lombard's House is written in red on the receipt, «rec'd by checks 750. / commission to Rehn 250.» (Book IV, leaf 101, ref 17933), and the Circle Theatre, «\$1,800», is the first dollar sign and comma in the money column. From 1938 to 1955 one sale is written down the leaf four or five times: the items at list price, each marked «o», «w.c» or «E»; a rule across the money column and the sum; «less commission», which names either the deduction or the net, the same words for both; «less photos»; the net restated; the red cheque. And from 1955 the entry is the gallery's statement, headed «Rec'd from Rehn Gallery», sometimes with the cheque number, «check No 6388 date Feb 14 / Empire Trust Co 7798 43» (Book IV, leaf 140, ref 18250), and sometimes with the pictures counted and not priced: «10 water colors / 4 drawings / 3 etchings / 3 oils 16,514 65» (Book IV, leaf 141, ref 16957). By then the book is no longer an invoice book but a record of what arrived.

The prices can be read across the decades. Watercolours at 100 net in 1924, 166.67 in 1927; The City 600 in 1927; «Light House Hill (Scheffer) 1000»; Blackwell's Island 1666.67 net in 1929; «Church So. Truro» / «Tables for Ladies» 4200 gross in 1931; «Room in Brooklyn» 1200 to Boston; «From Williamsburg Bridge 2000» in 1937; «o Cape Cod Afternoon 3800 / o. Compartment C Car 293 1000» in 1938; «New York Movie» 2500; «Night Hawks» 3000» and «Dawn in Pennsylvania» 2000» in 1942; «Gas» 1800» in 1943; «Hotel Lobby» 2500; «Rooms for Tourists oil 3000»; «1 oil Rooms by the Sea 4000 00» in 1952; «Morning in a City 6000 00»; «1 oil Hotel Room» 5500 00»; «Sunlight in a Cafeteria 9000 00» in 1958; «November Washington Square / Santa Barbara Museum / Mrs Sterling Morton 10,000.00» in 1960; «Girlie Show (Charles Stein) 11000 00»; «People in the Sun» 15000 00»; «Excursion into Philosophy» \$14500.00»; «New York Office» 16500.00 / Lawrence Fleischman»; «Sun in an Empty Room» 25000 00»; «balance on Intermission 25000 00». The largest single cheque in the book is 17,737.84, on 11 January 1958, against Rehn's statement of 28 December 1957; the largest of the 1940s was 4357.76 and of the 1920s 3380.17.

Until 1954 the pocket book names almost no buyers: «(Phillips)», «(Mrs Coburn)», «(Scheffer)», in brackets, and museums as destinations. Leaf 133 is «the first leaf in Book IV to name a buyer», and only in a pencil margin: «Roy Neuberger» against the Barber Shop, «Jo Hirshhorn» against four pictures. Stephen Clark, the collector of Book III, is not in Book IV at all. From 1961 the buyer is in the charge line, because the gallery's statement now carried it. The pocket book is the dealer's side of the record; the work books are the painter's.

5.5 *The instalments*

In the 1960s a picture is paid for in parts, and the book writes each part as an entry of its own. «Excursion into Philosophy / on acct. 5000 00» among the items of 24 January 1962; then, on 23 June, the picture at \$14,500 with «Less payment on account / " 1/24/1962 / "Excursion into Philosophy" 3333.34» taken off the net, which is the five thousand less a third. «A Woman in the Sun 10000.00» in June 1962; «"A Woman in the Sun" 15000.00 / Mr & Mrs Albert Hackett» in January 1963 with «Payment on Account / Hackett — 6666.67» deducted. «Road and Trees 15000 00 / Rehn Gallery / John Clancy purchase» twice on one leaf, 7500 received on account in July 1963 and 2500 as the balance in December, no commission line, the two receipts making two thirds of the price: the dealer bought it for himself (Book IV, leaf 154, ref 17869). «Intermission 6,000 00» on account in December 1965; «balance on Intermission 25000 00 / less 33 1/3 8333 33 / 16666 67 / Dec. 16, 1965 / Payment on acct 6000 00 / check — 10666 67» in July 1966 (Book IV, leaf 158, ref 16958). Chair Car: «payment on account / "Chair Car" 10,000 00» in December 1965, «Balance on Chair Car / recd by check 8,000 00 / to be deposited by John / in Bank of New York on / Jan 1, 1967» in December 1966, and the full price never written anywhere in the book. Read row by row, every one of those pictures was charged twice and the years 1962 and 1963 read 25,000 high; the edition's reader collapses them and says so. A historian using this book for income has to know that the book was not kept for that purpose. It was kept to know what had come in.

5.6 *What the book says it counts*

Once, in fifty-four years, the book states a rule about itself. Against a Kennedy sale of a Cat Boat print on 14 January 1944, in a smaller upright pencil, «Take note» and «not included in income.», with a pencil cross in the money column where a figure would be (Book IV, leaf 116, ref 18385). The transcription calls it «the only place in ten batches where the book says what it counts». Refunds and insurance are left out of the sums, prizes inconsistently; a loan is counted, «Insurance on Capt Ed / Staples from Cleveland Mus. 1000» in 1929, the picture that burnt on the train. Money going the other way is written too: «Cape & Vineyard Electric Co / for electric line at Truro 914 00», in pencil, unreceipted (Book IV, leaf 143, ref 18525), which is the electricity the black notebook's chronicle says they «began efforts for» in 1951 and «got» in September 1954; «Paid \$5000.00 on Fed Income Tax / Feb. 15, 1957» in pencil under the cheque of 16,514.65; «Frame for Dauphinee House -48 00»; «Relining of "East River" / (cleaning and varnishing) 190 00 / Frame by Kulicke for / "East River" 144 00».

The year totals she wrote from leaf 114 onward, in pencil, are the check on the whole reading. «1942 — 5857.44»; «1949 total 3661.14»; «Total 1955» 13406.49 with its last digit cut by the binding; «Total 39842.56» for 1962. Where the leaf's own arithmetic closes, the edition's receipts stream reconciles with it to the cent: 1946, 1947, 1949, 1951, 1961, 1962. Where it does not, the difference is named: ten dollars short in 1952, «Thirty-six dollars are unaccounted for» in 1958, the thousand-dollar award left out of 1960. The book also moves money between years and says so: seven thousand dollars of 1954 receipted again in 1955 with «delayed receipt Re Zucker — p income Tax» beside it; a cheque of 27

December 1955 «Jan 3 deposited»; the Chair Car balance dated 15 December 1966 and entered again on 1 January 1967. These are not errors. They are a cash book keeping cash-basis accounts against a tax year, and the tax year was the reason the totals began to be labelled at all.

5.7 The last leaf

Leaf 158 carries the only writing in the volume the edition cannot place. «Dec. 15, 1966 / Balance on Chair Car» is «written in blue and then written again in black over the blue, word for word and a little out of register», and the deposit note «in red and then written again in black over the red». Nothing is added or altered; somebody went over the last entries a second time, and nothing on the leaf says who.

Leaf 159, 1967, holds three entries, each with a bare red figure under the black charge: the 8000 deposited by Clancy on 1 January; the Museum of Modern Art's 100 «for reproduction of House by / a Railroad, Illustration / on jacket / The "American Tradition / in Literature"»; and the last entry in Book IV: «Mar. 23 Rec'd from Artex Prints / Royalties on Light House a 2 lights / by Artex Junior / recd by check Mar 14. 28 83», with a red «Mar 16 28 23» beneath, «receipted twice at two figures a fortnight apart». Twenty-eight dollars in royalties on a reproduction of a lighthouse painted in 1929, seven weeks before he died. «The rest of the leaf is empty.» The back cover: «No hand has written on it.»

Nothing in the volume is dated after 23 March 1967. Ninety-two leaves earlier, the same hand had written «2 line drawings / "The Iron Stickpin" 20 00». The whole of a working life is between them, and the book never once says what any of it was for.

Book V and the dealers' book: the prints by whose hands they passed through

6.1 *Book V, for drawings*

Book V is sixteen sheets and it announces itself: « This book for drawings, not water colors. » in lighter pencil on the stationer's thumb-indexed leaf that serves as its index (Book V, index, ref 16748). The index is of the book itself: « Early Drawings at Rehn Gal. — left there July 8, 1957. p. 1-5. »; « Etchings — p. 51. »; « Loans for travelling shows »; « Not yet identified — but sold — P. 6 ». A leaf holds two to four of Edward Hopper's ink record drawings down the left, a title and a measurement in pencil under each, and beside each one line of hers: buyer, price, the third off, date. There is no exhibition table, no verdict column, no running total.

The drawings went, in June and July 1959 and January 1962, for 150 to 600 dollars: « Houses on Skyline 12x18 ("Shacks") » to George Mladinich, « $175 - 1/3 = 116 \frac{2}{3}$ »; Two Big Trees, « Cape Ann 1922. », to Wilson Kierstead at 200; Gloucester House to Dr. B. Nathanson at 600, the highest; « Two Nudes - Man + Woman » to Alfredo Valente at 225. The buyers are annotated in pencil afterwards with what she knew of them, « friend of John Lamb?? in big advertising Co. / came here with Grace Root », « Ridgewood, N.J. owns Talbot's House given to Frank Rehn », and, struck through on the one ruled table, « Wm. Ziegler - Indiana Baby Food, reducing pills » with « Paid » in the margin (Book V, leaf 6, ref 18118). Two leaves record no transaction at all: they hold the drawings he gave her, inscribed inside the sketch in his hand, « To Josie E. H. », « For Jo Edward Hopper », « To Jo from E. Hopper » (Book V, leaf 7, ref 17426; Book V, leaf 9, ref 17499). One is lent: « Loaned for Exhibition at National Arts Club - / May 3, 1959. ... Price \$400. Owned by Jo N. Hopper / for her collection. » The loans page has a single loan, a sanguine, « Femme Endormie ... to Boston Public Library — Dessins Américains Contemporains / to travel in Europe. Catalogue rec'd for Strasbourg. Sept-Oct. 1956. » and, in pencil, an unclosed « (Returned to studio ».

Leaves 51 to 53 are a different document. They are stock-takes of the etchings, and they are the sound of a widow trying to find out where the prints were. « Etchings at Rehn Gallery, Oct. 28, 1953. » heads leaf 51 (ref 16364), and under it « May 27, 1951. Frank Rehn took from studio in visit there, 11 Etchings :- » followed by nine titles; then a list of what the gallery had before that; then « From Kleeman Gallery 1953. »; then, as a heading, a question: « Where did Rehn's gallery get these 4/3 that they sold ? » The transcription warns that leaf 51 is « by a long way the densest leaf in the volume » and was read thirteenth

in a batch of twelve; a checking pass should start there. Leaf 52 copies a Rehn receipt of 2 July 1959, ten prints at thirty and fifty dollars, « 340. » less « $33 \frac{1}{3} - 113.33$ » = « 226.67 », and in the margin: « Where did they all come from? Not those owned by Jo Hopper², kept in gallery as examples, before E. H. gave up printing any more » (Book V, leaf 52, ref 17886).

The last written leaf records the end of the etchings as a stock: « Purchase of Etchings of Edward Hopper by the Philadelphia Museum of Art.² / Feb. 7", 1962. » « Check signed by Willard P. Graham for \$3500. This in recognition / via Carl Zigrosser of the whole oeuvre of E. H. as etcher - / 162 samples of very early + later work - some in different stages of plate. » and « They will have an almost complete collection of the Hopper output of etchings + his few drypoints² » (Book V, leaf 53, ref 17721). Book IV writes the same transaction as « 105 etchings 3500.00 »; the counts do not agree, and neither leaf is corrected from the other.

6.2 *The dealers' book*

The sixth volume is a stationer's cash book, « CASH » on the cover, whose front half was used for something else, so that its leaves begin at 51. It is, as its transcription says, « indexed by whose hands the work was in ». Leaf 51 closes with two index tables ringed in red pencil: a general one (Downtown Gallery 75 and 82, Whitney Club 78, Babcock 89, Mrs. Sterner 57, Kleemann-Thorman 83, Allison 58, Root and the Utica Museum 59) and one headed « Etchings Dealers »: Sterner 88, Weyhe 76, Jennings 80, Keppel 70, Kennedy 85 and 73, Milch 88, Randolph 74, Sidney Phillips 89, Kraushaar 72, Denko 73, and « Rehn - See other book ». Each dealer gets a leaf, and the prints move down it: delivered, price, sold, amount received, returned.

Two sentences on the Keppel leaves are the rule for reading every print sale in the archive, and they should be quoted wherever an impression's provenance is built from these books:

Date of sale = date that payment is rec'd. by the artist. This statement does not refer to the particular copy of the print after which it is entered as the particular / as copies are not numbered + cannot be kept track of. Hence discrepancy in prices - print sold at delivery
(Dealers, leaf 71, ref 17690)

Dates of sale do not belong to the particular print listed - it means any print of that name.
(Dealers, leaf 72, ref 17297)

Hopper did not number his impressions. The ledger row that says a Night Shadows was delivered to Keppel on 12 January 1923 and sold on 5 March 1927 records a print of that name going out and a print of that name being paid for, not the same sheet, and the keeper of the book knew it and wrote it down twice.

The terms are what the volume is for. Weyhe's Book Shop, the earliest dealer entry in the book, took prints on 3 May 1921 and sold Night in the Park and Evening Wind at nine dollars each in November, a 40 per cent discount on fifteen; two of its prints went « Gone to Denmark. Mar. 1926. » and one was « Gift to Zigrosser » (Dealers, leaf 76, ref 16476). Kennedy took half: « Railroad x 2 - Com. 50% ! » and « Deux Pigeons - Protested 50% Com. » (Dealers, leaf 73, ref 18070). The Whitney Studio Club took a tenth. Sterner took 30 per cent. From 1927 the third is general, and on 8 December 1928 the price rose: « Increase in prices - 25 to 30 / R. R. Crossing 18 to 25 », with the new figures written over

the struck old ones row by row on the Downtown Gallery's leaf (Dealers, leaf 71, ref 17690; Dealers, leaf 75, ref 18023). When a museum bought through a dealer, two commissions came off: «Boston Mus. 30 - 15% Kep. 28 1/2», and seventeen dollars reached the artist.

The book records, above all, the trouble of keeping track. Edith Halpert's Downtown Gallery returned its consignment in June 1934 and April 1935, and the leaf carries the reconciliation: «Account closed, prints returned ... with the slight discrepancy in inventories - but all prints are accounted for - all have been returned. There has been a substitution of names in its inventories from DownTown Gal. - according to which there would be 2 extra East Side Int. + 1 extra Amer. Landscape. But these replace 1 Lonely House, 1 Night Shadows, 1 Even. Wind, otherwise unaccounted for.» (Dealers, leaf 82, ref 17514). Weyhe's returned its stock while the Hoppers were in Mexico in 1943: «Etchings returned to 3 Wash. Sq. in Aug. or Sept. 1943. We in Mexico. package rec'd by Mrs. Waters, Supt. here. ... Package opened Oct. 17, 43 to find. 4 missing ... and 1 extra East Side Interior. — They not supposed to have.» (Dealers, leaf 77, ref 16433). Keppel's, which had become Harlow's, closed in the same year: «Rec'd from Harlow, Mar. 25, 43 - / 39 prints. / but on record for Keppel & Harlow Co. / only 28 prints. / Turn up unaccounted for 11 prints.»; twelve of the thirty-nine went to Allison's, and the leaf ends «Account closed.» (Dealers, leaf 84, ref 16360). Kennedy's sold without asking: «Lonely House paid only 17, Dec. 8, 53 - we not consulted.»; «East Side Interior - June ? 1951. Sold for \$43[?] or \$50. We in Mexico, not consulted. \$28 rec'd ?»; and, in the margin, «Kennedy got it. Don't know when» (Dealers, leaf 85, ref 18068). The last dealer transaction in the book is Kennedy's, 15 February 1957, and the last date is Zigrosser's visit «again ± Mar. 1961. re cataloguing Amer. Etchers / for information very detailed»: the Philadelphia purchase of 1962 was being prepared, from these leaves.

The Rehn leaves at the back, 90 to 95, are «the whole back of the book». They hold the Gloucester and Rockland watercolours of 1926 with one-line descriptions and her verdicts in the date column: «Manhattan Bridge entrance - big arch - best of the Lot.» against «Painted spring 1926 Brought to R. later in fall - not so good -» (Dealers, leaf 93, ref 17434); «Talbot's House (Rockland) - fine white mansard Bgt. by Rehn - Oct. 200 - 1/3 = 133 1/3 Nov. 1926»; and the first oils through the gallery, «Fall 1925 750 House by a Railroad - invited by New Society - 600 - 200 Com.» / «To Mr. Steven Clark - Mar. 20, 26 paid June 11, 26» (Dealers, leaf 91, ref 17125). On leaf 94, «Oils - ready for Hopper», the Automat stands over a struck «The Cafeteria[?]»: the picture had another name for a moment.

6.3 *Her own leaves*

The dealers' book closes, like the etchings collection in Book I, on Josephine Hopper's own work. Leaves 62, 63 and 96 to 98 are her record: the Whitney Studio Galleries' Christmas show of 1929, «Total sold \$50. less 25% = \$37.50 Rec'd Dec. 26, '29», «Sold to Mrs. Force»; and the juries, which is a list of refusals. «Submitted to Va. Museum show - Guy du Bois chairman - thrown out.» «Artists for Victory at Met. 1941 ... thrown out.» Corcoran and Chicago in 1943, «Invited - E. H. on jury.» «Mar. 18' 46. Turned down by jury of [illegible] Club (thy lowest depths [illegible] Pen & Brush!» (Dealers, leaf 97, ref 16956). The hole in the leaf at that line is missing paper, the transcriber says, not a

hard reading. The last line of the book is hers: «Interior of the Ascensions - water color - shown in parish house of the Ascension - late Lent 1952.» (Dealers, leaf 98, ref 17161).

Set beside the tally she made on leaf 56, «Sales 34 / Gifts 5 / Dealers 20 / 59», and the twenty dealers counted by name, these leaves are the difference between the two painters at 3 Washington Square North in a single volume: his prints going out through twenty dealers and coming back with discrepancies, hers going to a jury and coming back thrown out. The Garrulities notebook is the commentary on that difference, and it is the next chapter.

The notebooks: the other half of the same working life

7.1 *Four of ninety*

The Whitney counts ninety notebooks of Josephine Hopper's in the Sanborn Hopper Archive and has digitised four. The Provincetown Art Association holds twenty-two diaries of 1933 to 1956, and Madeleine Larson's typescript of them, in five parts, is used here through the edition's timeline. What follows is written from the four the Whitney serves as photographs, because those are the four whose reading can be checked against the hand, and it uses the typescript where the ledgers and the notebooks need a date or a sentence that only the diary gives.

The four are not of one kind. *Garrulities + Grouch*, subtitled «When Artists Meet», is a diary of the marriage as it bore on her painting, kept at long intervals from 1927 to 1959. *Re: 3 Wash Sq* and *Battle of Wash Sq.* are the working file and the memorandum book of the fight of 1947. The black two-ring notebook is a book of lists. Between them they supply what the ledgers leave out: what the studio cost to run, what the frames were, what the pictures were called before they were named, what she thought of him, and what she thought of herself.

7.2 *Garrulities + Grouch*

The title page is in pencil: «Garrulities + Grouch.», a rubbed-out line, «When Artists Meet.», and three more erased lines nobody can read (*Garrulities*, p. 1, ref 97409). The book turns to ink on page 4 and stays in ink until a blue-grey entry of 1956. Its dates are in the margin, and it was not written front to back: an entry of 25 April 1928 follows one of the 27th, and a January 1952 entry follows February's. The transcription keeps the book's order. The subject, sustained over thirty-one years and twenty-two dated entries, is stated in the second: «If ever E.H. comes across these notes, he wo'nt find anything that he has'nt heard several times to his face. We say everything - at least I do - + bless his heart, he takes it.» (20 Feb. 1928, *Garrulities*, p. 14, ref 96263).

The longest entry, of 6 February 1928, runs ten pages and contains the grievance whole. Before the marriage he had made her eleven frames for her exhibition, carried her water-colours to the Brooklyn International, written to Chicago on her behalf. A year after it, «E.H. introduced the man from the Cleveland Mus. to his wife - + never mentioned the fact that she too was an artist -! That did something to me from which I've never recovered. ... For 3 1/2 yrs. my water colors have roosted on their rack and no living mortal passing

our threshold has had the vaguest curiosity regarding the nature of them.» (Garrulities, p. 11, ref 97273). «for so long I have'nt had any identity at all. People have been lovely + cordial to me but only as his wife» (p. 5). «his contributions to his wife have been chiefly inhibitions.» (p. 12). The same entry describes his work in a sentence that is also a description of her own: «remote + chilled + realistic - and strong + honest - + pessimistic + succinct - as no woman's work can ever be.» (p. 5, ref 96067). And it describes him: «Tall + lanky + "a Lincoln-like". Same height as Lincoln 6 ft. 4. And honest + humorous + essentially kindly. (Except when his Egotism shuts it out)» (p. 9), with the Rehn show of 1924 remembered as «"the best thing since Winslow Homer" was the shout at his first show at Rehns - off in a little back rooms, 11 water colors».

The entry also contains a staged exhibition. The morning after a quarrel she laid out on his worktable four «Exhibits», her fragile treasures each paired with one of his tools, an ear-ring with a hammer, a lace handkerchief with a lump of coal, under a sign: «"Opportunity Gallery / Humor + destructiveness of Edward invited." I lost a minute - could'nt think - it was Egotism - not destructiveness that I'd planned.» He put everything back tenderly and corrected her spelling of «Oppertunity» (p. 6, ref 97505). It is the one exhibition in the archive that she curated, and it was reviewed by its only visitor.

Then the entries that make the notebook painful to read. 25 April 1928: «An encounter with an Egotist is like beating one's head against a stone wall. The wall is in no wise affected.» (p. 18); «he beat me well over the head with his fists, or palms - I do'nt know which — for good + sufficient reason: I'd upset his bureau drawers ... But what can you do when they're 6 ft. 4 + have hands like iron clamps» (p. 21, ref 97465); «I ca'nt paint out of disgust. It's a knife in the breast. He knows this — + he works it.» (p. 23). 23 November 1930: the easel she brought into the studio in 1925 over his objection, and «now that his resistance is withdrawn my so slight a giftie has given up me — died in the squabble. ... All the dishes that have been washed, the bacon fried, floors swept, socks darned — avail nothing.» (p. 28, ref 97196). 17 February 1934, written in bed with a cold: «By any chance have I married a sadist?» (p. 37); «I am a woman — + deny, stamp it out having first uprooted — I am also an artist.» (p. 43, ref 96250); and, at a Whitney party, a title offered for a picture: «"What'll I call it?" I was asked + said: "Damned Egotists." E.H. here at my side said Why not "God Damned Egotists" — + brought down the house.» (p. 36).

The record is not one-sided, and its keeper knew it. The broken ankle of January 1931 makes him «King of beast and best nurse + cook + house maid + janitor of all the best artists in America to-day» (p. 31, ref 96245), and «I might better be writing a book about the cute things he says. ... He says it's always too intimate, no one would get it but me.» (p. 30). The wedding day, told in September 1939 because Guy Pène du Bois had told it wrong, has the Little Church Around the Corner refusing them because he had never been baptised, church after church in the July heat, and the little French church on West Fifteenth Street with the concierge and his wife as witnesses; «when E.H., who tells his business to no one, short: "We're going to be married!" said he.» (p. 48, ref 96072). The head margin of that page carries, fifteen years after the event, the one statement of the date: «Married July 9, 1924.»

The later entries are about the institutions. 5 December 1948, after Lloyd Goodrich has telephoned about the 1950 retrospective: «The Whitney has made of itself a clearing

house + if one isn't seen there, no dealer will look at one, it has the effect of an official boycott. ... She hated women, especially wives.» (p. 56, ref 97076), the *she* being Juliana Force, dead that year; «a lone wallflower pinned there to watch everybody else dance.» 19 June 1950, on Goodrich's Penguin monograph: «L. Goodrich has seen fit to delete "the artist." I can never forget that. ... The Whitney boycott is here complete — as an artist, historically, I'm not allowed to exist, even in my husband's biography. And that's all right with E.H.!» (p. 61, ref 96058), with a marginal correction that one of two references does say «J.N. a painter». 9 June 1954, a month before the thirtieth anniversary, when he «rather generously confessed» that he had not wanted her to paint and now withdrew his opposition, she wrote the anatomy: «The 3 points of attack, intent to destroy : 1 - the woman artist. 2. The essential woman + her pretensions to a sex life — 3. Ability to drive a car, which would include a mind of her own, an intellect.» (p. 73, ref 96115). And a critic's phrase, in 1954, that she found exact: «That's why his famous sunlight is without heat. Some critic said that. How extraordinarily perceiving. There is the light on fields + walls of houses, but you'll get no warming benefit — not from that man» (p. 71, ref 96268).

The book has one sustained happy passage at its end, the group show at the Greenwich Gallery in the spring of 1958, ten canvases: «my pictures felt they had waked up in heaven, they having here their prayers, so hopeful to be there where their color sang as never before. I was indeed proud of them.» (p. 77, ref 97417). It breaks off on page 79 with «Interrupted» underlined. Forty pages later, with the book turned upside down, two pencil copyings from Milton and Arthur Symons, and nothing else.

Three things about this notebook bear on the ledgers. First, it names the pictures of hers that the ledgers never do: the Obituary with the yellow cat, the Cape Cod bedroom, Washington Square Park from the window at 29 by 36, the studio stove with his crossed feet, Tenements from the End of Williamsburg Bridge finished on 20 February 1928 with the fire escapes left off «by both of us». Second, it explains the paint formula: the woman who wrote «Rembrandt colors» under his pictures for six years was a painter who inherited the Rembrandt colours when he changed to Winsor & Newton in May 1938. Third, and most important for reading Book II, it shows what the naming of figures was. The woman who wrote «Shirley» and «Olga» and «Nora» under his pictures was, in her own book, writing sentences like «Dear Miss Chamberlain said last night she loved my houses on tip toe. His houses, she told E.H., she knew had coal in their cellars.» (p. 5). The anecdotes under the paintings are not naive. They are the work of a writer who knew exactly what she was doing and did it in the only book anybody would read.

7.3 The Battle of Washington Square

In August 1946 the trustees of Sailors' Snug Harbor, ground landlords of the north side of Washington Square, gave New York University a twenty-one-year lease on numbers 1, 2 and 3, and the university applied to the Office of Price Administration for certificates of eviction against the tenants. The tenants of number 3 were artists, and the top floor had been Edward Hopper's since December 1913. Two of the four notebooks are about what followed.

Re: 3 Wash Sq is a stenographer's spiral pad with «Re. 3 Wash. Sq» pencilled on

the cover. It is not a diary. The transcription calls it a working draft, and its editorial rule follows from that: «The same sentences therefore recur three and four times, and never twice the same: names are added, spelled differently, or dropped. Nothing here is merged.» From the front she wrote drafts: a statement of the case written three times over, the third a fair copy to Whitelaw Reid of the *Herald Tribune* dated 10 February 1947; letters to Mayor LaGuardia in three drafts, to Paul Sachs of the Fogg, to Robert Moses, to Mayor O'Dwyer, to Dean Vanderbilt of the law school, to the rent attorney at the O.P.A.; press lists, guest lists, tax assessments. From the back, and running backwards through the photographs, she wrote a dated chronicle of the fight from January to 25 March, and the two met in the middle of the pad.

The argument of the drafts is about the house. «a terrible old house with no heat, high ceilings, long flights to climb, bath rooms - remote but even the bare walls beautiful A house frequently cussed but forever adored.» (3 Wash Sq, p. 7, ref 97317). «Painters require space to paint a picture that will carry across a room or a gallery. ... He needs north light. Space + light. These 2 things are rare finds - they are too expensive, no new studio buildings are being constructed» (p. 17, ref 97398), marked in red as the point to lead with. «The house is specially built for painters — there are 10 good north light studios + 5 large sky lights. The place reeks with tradition. It is as well adapted to painters as the aquarium to fishes.» (to O'Dwyer, p. 38, ref 96068). The roll of former tenants, Glackens and Edith Dimock, Guy Pène du Bois, Lawson, Rockwell Kent, Dos Passos, Cummings and the *Dial*, Edmund Wilson, Elinor Wylie, Eakins in Stokes's studio, the Gishes, is written out five times and never twice with the same names. «The house has produced 9 members of the Institute of Arts + Letters. Can't find one from that N.Y.U.» (p. 14).

And the argument is about him. «E. Hopper has just turned the 1/3 mark of a century, having spent the greater part of his life here + painted pictures that hang in museums clean across a continent in this old house» (p. 3, ref 96255). «I, as wife, know what it means to have my husband + his 33 years collection sent adrift in an overcrowded city but this issue is really larger than that.» (p. 15). To the O.P.A.: «One of the trustees of the Mus. of Mod. Art expressed the fear that if E.H. were so uprooted from #3 where he has spent the greater part of his life, his work would die. ... E.H. too is a landmark in Amer. painting of his day.» and, lower down, «My husband frowns on my writing you this — you may or may not find it irrelevant» (pp. 33–34). To Moses: «My husband was discouraged over your evasive letter. But my husband is known for understatement. (He leaves out everything that matters, one wonders he speaks up at all.)» (p. 36, ref 97184). The chronicle has him at the first hearing on 18 February, where the university did not appear: «E.H. Comment — since no N.Y.U. there “We tore at our own heartstrings”» (p. 47, ref 97377); at the press party of the 25th, sixty people at the Morses', «E.H. said he was for everything that has been said»; and on 18 March, «I get letter off to Ira A. Schiller by 11 P.M. E. dissenting plentifully but insisting he should have a woman's point of view.» (p. 44, ref 97538). He paid his share: «E.H. received bill from C. Hauptman for 50. + sends check same day. \$50 from each of 6 1/2 tenants» (p. 47).

Her own painting is in the pad at its edges. «Took cat water Color drawing to Teco Gallon² to Juried-in Show at» Macbeth, on 14 February (p. 47); «(This 2nd week waiting for visit to see my work by Macbeth Gal.) much depressed.» on 13 March; «Louise Morse invited me to hold show in their studio» / «E. H. thinks better not.» on the 20th or 21st

(p. 44). The fight and the neglect are on the same page, and she did not separate them.

The outcome is the last letter: «Beckley phoned 1/2 hr. ago to announce the O.P.A. decision to deny N.Y.U.'s request for certificate of eviction», 16 May 1947, and «The chief value of our victory in this major skirmish is that it reaffirms our profound belief that Wash Sq. belongs to the artists.» (p. 43, ref 97371). The other notebook, *Battle of Wash Sq.*, is a pocket memorandum book of eight sheets that sets the same dates on its first page, «Aug. 1946 Sailors Snug gave / lease to N.Y.U.» and «May 15th 1947. Decision / from O.P.A.», and lists the cast (Battle, p. 1, ref 89299). Its one dated entry is a board meeting of the Washington Square Neighbors on 30 November 1948, at which Owen Grundy of the *Villager* proposed that «“residential” be redefined as A - not incl. Educational, hospitals etc. so as to exclude N.Y.U.», and «Jane + I sat back of his shoulder blades.» (p. 3, ref 89300). The rest is a chronicle of demolitions: «Rhineland - Torn down - Dec. 1950 / White Marble House Jan 2», 51»; «S. side of Sq. - Torn down - / Palisade of studio windows / House of Genius»; «Summer 1953 - LaFayette demolished»; and «Frederick Stokes died at 97 - / Mar. or Feb. 1955», the dean of the house, whom the drafts had called «our polar explorer aged 88» and who «climbed up his 74 steps like a mountain goat» (Battle, p. 5, ref 89301; p. 6). A leaf between pages 8 and 9 was cut out; its stub reads «Dec ... Dec ... Feb ... Jan», a dated run somebody removed.

The victory held for thirteen years and then took a different form. Book III's Whereabouts leaf for 1960 has the university turning five studios into offices and putting in radiators, and the Book I Gifts leaf records the etchings given in May 1947 to the lawyer and the reporter «celebrating The Battle of Wash. Sq.» Her Who's Who entry, drafted in the black notebook, put it among her credentials: «Active in defense of The Battle of Washington Sq. 1947.» (Black notebook, p. 57, ref 97267). He died in the house in 1967; the university has it still.

7.4 *The black notebook*

The black two-ring notebook has nothing written on its cover and no object number. It is, in the transcription's words, «a household and studio memorandum book», and its subject changes every page or two. Its dated content runs from a driver's licence of August 1937 and a paper order of November 1937 to «Refound Oct. 14», 1964.»; the pencil sheets at the back are the oldest stratum and the ink at the front the 1950s. The first page boxes the address, «Mrs. Edward Hopper / 3 Washington Square North / New York 3 N.Y. / Phone Spring 7 - 0949. / also Truro, Cape Cod, Mass- / Her book?» (Black notebook, p. 1, ref 96076). Her book: the ledgers were his work in her hand; this was hers.

It is the one place in the archive where the costs of the studio are written. Frames, first: the makers, Usui, Heydenryk (spelt three ways), Robinson, Barbizon, Matt of East 54th Street, Burges-Revel of La Porte, Indiana; their prices, «Usui frame 25 x 30 - gold, pinkish? - \$18 / Heydenryk - 25 x 30 - goldish + white. 11.50»; and the one verdict on a frame in the whole corpus, «Matt - 25 x 30 was aluminum + gold + no good on anything. Too raw sienna - awful in north light. Gorgeous glittery in fluorescent now worse - more yellow than before.» (p. 18, ref 97168). One bill she ruled as a table, Burges-Revel's of 28 February 1958: model 200 with insert, 29 by 36, finish 2R, 30.75; the same in 25 by 30, 26.75; two of model 214 at 22.75 and 21.00; and a key to what went in them, «29 x 36

= Wash. Sq. from Studio window / 25 x 30 = Fire Escape + Convent opposite / 22 x 32
= Buick in Cal. Canyon / 20 x 28 = Cape studio from attic stairs - rug, lamp» (p. 54, ref 97360). These are her pictures. The frames in the black notebook are almost all for her own work, and the one frames page that carries his titles, Chop Suey in «old metal» at 32 by 38, Shakespeare at Dusk, is a list of old frames in the rack (p. 122, ref 98173). A recipe for finishing plain wood, taken down from the painter Bertram Hartman, «1. Shellac. / 2. White shoe polish liquid / 3. Rub in dry color - pastel - / 4. Wax.» (p. 6, ref 96080), is the one instruction for making anything in a book of lists.

Paper is priced by the pound of the ream and the cent of the sheet: «Coper Union - 72 lbs. - 20 ¢ / 140" 39 ¢ / See Robinson - 72" 23 ¢ / 90" 37 ¢ / 140" 50 ¢» (p. 9, ref 97564), and the sheet sizes of Whatman and Lindenmeyr are set down for cutting mats. Insurance on the Truro house, a family theft policy of a thousand dollars at \$22.50 and windstorm on «Cottage + Garage» at five, taken out in December 1947, stands on a page afterwards cancelled with a pencil cross, the two expiry lines ringed (p. 11, ref 97318). «Studio + Bedroom painted 2 Coats - Casein / May 19 1953. - 4 day job. \$250 or 350?» (p. 25). A Macy wrist watch bought in May 1945 for ten dollars, cleaned in 1950 for 3.98, the total «7.47» and then «7.67 — Why?» (p. 123). A phonograph, «Even exchange for Colombia bgt. Mar 28, 60 / \$153.99», undelivered and reported to Mrs. Payne at Schirmer's (p. 51). The burglary: «1958 - Feb. 11" Burglar visitation - Money ± 115. + also / Amer. Ex. Checks - ± 900.» (p. 47, ref 97055). A pencil table of his measurements, «E. Suit Size», waist 38, chest 42, «Neck - 15 1/2. but work shirts 16.» (p. 16).

Two chronicles of the years are in it, one kept backwards from 1961 to 1906 and one forwards from 1941 to 1958, and they do not meet. The backwards one gives a line to a year and the lines are the skeleton the timeline uses: «1934 - Cape - Built house.»; «1933 Cape - last yr. at Bird's Cage. / Bgt. land.»; «1927 - Two Lights - Coast Guard Cottage ... got car - Dodge»; «1924 Gloucester. Honeymoon. / Watercolors. Chicago August.»; and before 1924 the years are hers alone: «1915 - Monhegan ? Wash Sq. Players.»; «1914 - Provincetown + Ogunquit», «7 Haarlem, Italy». The forwards one is the hospitals and the honours: «1948. Jan. Group of 6 or 7 paintings at Rehn. / very successful.» then «Feb. N.Y. Hospital - Prostate / Grosvenor Hotel when left Hospital / Stayed into May / 3 trips to N.Y. Hos. hemorrhages.»; «1950 N.Y. Hospital - Diverticulosis ... Feb. - Retrospective Ex. Hopper, Man of the Year / at Whitney Mus. - W. 8" St. E. in hospital / at opening of Exhib.» (p. 45, ref 97471); «1957 - Dec. 17 - 1958 Jan. 23" E.H. to N.Y. Hos. again / Prostate operations - 2 of them.» A page turned sideways puts the Mexican journeys straight, «To get this straight / Mexico — / 1943 Mex. City, Saltillo, Monterrey / 1946 - Sattillo - Grand Tetons / 1951 Sattillo - Santa Fé / 1952 - 53 - El Paso ... / 1955 ... / 1956, 57 - Calif.» (p. 48).

And it has the only sentence of Edward Hopper's about his purpose that any of the ten books records, boxed in red crayon:

Jan 1946. Quoting E. H. / Cruelly pinned down to definition / of his purpose generally,
I extract: / "the arrestation of a moment / in time - with the most acute / realization.
(Black notebook, p. 64, ref 98119)

A second boxed version below it, «to arrest / a moment in time / that moment / most acutely realized.», the transcription is careful to say, is «her own recasting of the first, not

a second saying of his ». Cruelly pinned down: the phrase is hers, and the word for what she did to get the sentence is the word she used for what he did to her.

The notebook also holds the tenants of number 3 from Glackens on, with «E.H. came in 1913» written diagonally beside the list (p. 117, ref 98176); the lions of number 6, «S. Kitson facit / John Morron got them 1883 / from Vanderbilt house upper 5" Ave.» (p. 121); a list of subjects still to paint, «Lions # 6 ... Eddie at work. / Playground - Wash. Sq. N. / In rear studio - self portrait in "dangerous" hat.» (p. 128, ref 98181); the drawings he gave her, «Owned by J.H. gift of E.H. / Helen Hayes House - "Pretty Penny" / preliminary to water color. / ... Girlie Show - preliminary, crayon.» (p. 59); the two watercolours given to the Museum of Modern Art's soldiers' sale of May 1942 and «Not exhibited so took back» (p. 63); a picture «stolen at Martha Jackson Gallery 1954» (p. 31); the mailing lists of *Reality*, the realist painters' broadsheet of 1953–55, ninety names with roman numerals for the numbers sent; her Who's Who entry twice; four days of his cold in March 1938 with the temperature taken hour by hour; a reading list that runs from Havelock Ellis to *Ethan Frome*; recipes, «Keep rare in middle - so fibre not toughened + unfit to eat.»; and, in 1962, under a heading «Little Frying Pans - for girls», the word «Career» written above and struck below (p. 61, ref 97387).

Her marks are a small grammar of their own, and the transcription's glossary records them: a raised double stroke after a numeral is an ordinal, not an inch mark, so «Dec. 6" 1956» is the sixth and «46 x 35 1/2"» is inches; «c̄» is *with*; «±» is *about*; a tick on a mailing list means «came or wrote» on one page and «wrote or rec'd. by hand» on the next, and both keys are hers. Names are spelt as she spelt them each time, Sattillo and Sortillo and Saltillo, Athenuem and Athenium, and the transcription lets each stand because the leaf did.

7.5 *What the notebooks do to the ledgers*

Read on their own, the ledgers are the record of a successful painter kept by a devoted wife. Read beside the notebooks, they are the record of two painters kept by the one whose work was not being recorded, in a house they had to fight to keep, with money that arrived through a dealer who died leaving no provision for what he owed, in frames that were «awful in north light». Neither reading is wrong. The ledgers say what a picture cost and where it went; the notebooks say what it cost to be the person who wrote that down. The sentence in the first is the wife's; the sentence in the second is the artist's; and it was the same hand.

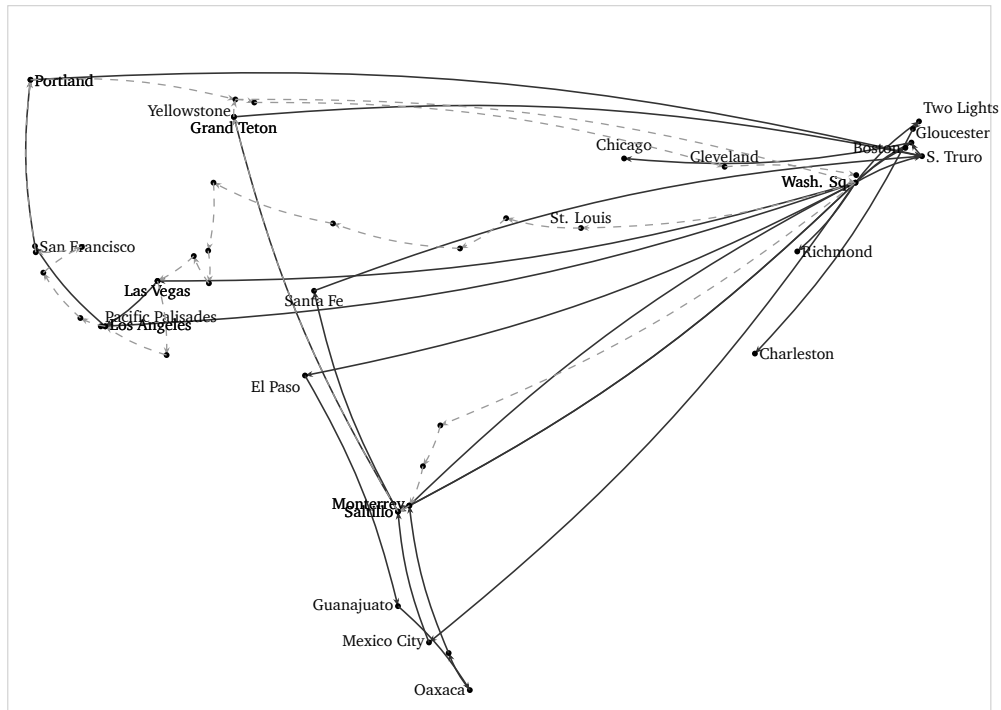


Figure 7.1: Where the black notebook and the Provincetown typescripts put the Hoppers, drawn at true relative position from coordinates retrieved from OpenStreetMap: solid arrows are Josephine Hopper's year chronicle and her list « To get this straight » of the Mexican journeys, one arrow per leg in the order she wrote them, each year starting from 3 Washington Square North; dashed arrows are the 1941 « Grand Tour of the West » and the 1946 Mexico journey as Madeleine Larson's typescripts give them day by day. It is the order two records fall in, not an itinerary; the ledgers, which record what left the studio and not where anybody was, cannot draw this. After the Timeline tab. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from travels.json (2026-09-13); coordinates © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL 1.0.

How the data was made: the engineering behind the figures

Every figure and every quotation in this note comes out of a pipeline, and a reader who wants to argue with a number needs to know which stage produced it and what that stage refused to do. This chapter describes the pipeline as it stood on 13 September 2026, stage by stage, in the order the data flows. It is the edition’s method, not mine, and where it is quoted the words are the scripts’ own headers.

8.1 *The inventory: harvested by a person, committed as text*

The Whitney publishes its photographs of the ledgers through ResourceSpace, one image to a resource reference, with a descriptor for each («Page 62 [horizontal orientation, “Fall 1927...”] »). The images answer a plain HTTP request; the HTML pages that list them sit behind a JavaScript bot-check, and the project does not impersonate a browser to get past it. So the inventory of the ten collections, six ledgers and four notebooks, was harvested by a person in a browser with a twelve-line snippet, and the result was committed as ten text files under `harvest/`. From those, `scripts/catalogue.mjs` generates a typed catalogue in which the museum’s descriptors survive unaltered; the one thing it infers is the leaf number the Hoppers wrote on the paper, parsed out of the descriptor and marked as inferred. The continuous integration workflow regenerates the catalogue on every push and fails if the committed file differs, so the catalogue cannot drift from the harvest.

Three numbers overlap on every sheet and the data model keeps them apart: the leaf number written on the paper, which names six different things across six volumes; the museum’s sequence number, which counts photographs, covers and versos included; and the ResourceSpace reference, which is in no order at all and is the only identifier that names exactly one image. Every citation in this note prints the leaf and the reference for that reason.

8.2 *Nothing of the archive is stored*

Not one photograph is in the repository or on any disk of the project’s. The reading view puts an image element straight at the Whitney’s file, fetched as it is looked at; the `.gitignore` refuses `*.jpg`. This was measured rather than assumed: on 5 September 2026 the museum’s download endpoint was found to answer cross-origin requests, to echo the requesting origin into its CORS header, to hold a current certificate, to check no referer and to honour byte ranges, so no relay is needed. The largest published size, 1292 by 2000 pix-

els, is about 170 pixels per inch across a leaf, and was checked to be legible for Josephine Hopper's figures before anything else was built. Only a transcription pass needs sheets on disk; `npm run mirror` fetches twelve at a time into a git-ignored directory, sleeping ten seconds between sheets as the museum's `robots.txt` asks, and `npm run tiles` cuts each into overlapping crops at twice size, because «choosing crop rectangles is not reading».

8.3 *The transcription: a restricted language, and what it refuses*

A batch is twelve sheets, read in one fresh context by a model the skill accepts (Fable 5.1, Fable 5 or Opus 5; any other is refused), and written as a LaTeX file whose header names the model, the date, and what was hard. The file uses a deliberately small set of macros, defined in `transcripts/preamble/hopper.sty`, and each one is a claim of a particular kind: `\sheet{ref}{leaf}` opens a sheet and is what turns the photograph when the transcript is scrolled; `\hand{}` attributes a hand to Josephine, to Edward, to a later writer or to nobody, and *unidentified* is a permitted and frequent answer; `\ill{}` marks what could not be read and is never guessed; `\uncertain{}` offers a reading and flags it; `\struck{}` keeps what the writer crossed out; `\note{}` is the transcriber's, `\marginal{}` the Hoppers'; `\sketch{}` stands where Edward Hopper's record drawing is; `\ink{}` records the colour, red, pencil or blue, of a cell where the leaf's colour means something; `\entry{as written}{ISO date}` opens a diary entry with the writer's date and the transcriber's date kept apart; and `ledgertable` carries the ruled columns.

The governing rule is stated in the method: «a guessed figure is a sale that did not happen». Nothing is expanded, nothing is normalised, nothing is corrected; «Inv.» stays «Inv.», «30 - 1/3» stays as written, and a name spelt four ways stays spelt four ways. There is one edition and no second register, because a ledger's English is plain and a second text would be a second artifact to keep in step. The renderer, `scripts/render.mjs`, accepts only that subset and fails loudly outside it, naming the file, the line and the construct, on the principle that «a silently mangled ledger is a table of numbers that look right»; it also refuses a resource reference that is not in the harvest and a file that omits the rights line.

What the transcription is not is checked. `transcripts/status.json` can hold two states no file can prove, *checked* and *skipped*, and it holds neither for any batch. Everything else the site says about progress is observed by `scripts/manifest.mjs` from the files on disk, «so that a progress figure can never claim work that was not done». One reading in Book I is marked as checked by a person; the rest is a first pass.

8.4 *The derived files, and the rule that a build must fail*

From the `.tex` alone, scripts derive everything the site and this note use, and each script's header says what it counts and what it therefore is not.

`scripts/tei.mjs` writes a TEI P5 file per transcription by a one-to-one mapping of the macros onto TEI elements, `\ill{}` to `<gap reason="illegible"/>`, `\uncertain{}` to `<unclear>`, and re-reads no sheet; `scripts/tei-validate.mjs` validates the result against the project's own customisation of fourteen element specifications, because, as its header records, the export was well-formed XML and invalid TEI for as long as nothing had asked. `scripts/citation.mjs` generates the citation files from a census of what is transcribed, on

the ground that a hand-written figure «is wrong from the next batch onward». `scripts/glossary.mjs` builds the key to the abbreviations and price notations from hand-declared entries, each carrying a search pattern, and fails the build if an entry matches no leaf; the search runs over the books' own writing and never over a `\note{}`, so that an entry cannot cite as evidence the sentence written because of it. `scripts/framing.mjs` applies the same rule to the black notebook's frames and sums. `scripts/streak.mjs` resolves every dated row to a calendar day and says, in its header, that the result records the days the books record something and not the days anybody worked. `scripts/formats.mjs` reads the size out of the title line only, in his hand, and rounds nothing. `scripts/materials.mjs` reads the paint formula out of `\hand{}` bodies only, never out of a note or a marginal, and counts once per work. `scripts/works.mjs` retrieves the museum holdings of each titled work from five institutions' public APIs, checks the artist field on every record, and states that a link says a work of this title is held there and not that the row concerns that copy. `scripts/notes.mjs` refuses a per-work note whose source key does not resolve. `scripts/places.mjs` refuses a journey whose sourced event it cannot find in the timeline. The CI workflow runs the catalogue, the renderer, the TEI export and validation, the manifest, the citation, the glossary, the framing and the spending scripts, compares each generated file with the committed one, proves the accounts and the Book IV reader in Lean (next section but two), and only then builds the site.

8.5 *The accounts reader*

The figures in the accounts chapter and Tables A.1 to A.6 come from `scripts/accounts.mjs`, which has two readers because the books have two shapes.

The work-books reader counts a row only where the leaf puts a price in one cell and a date in another, because the column a date stands in is what says whether it dates the sale or the cheque. On the oils leaves the first column dates the sale; on the etchings leaves it dates the exhibition, so those rows are set aside as unparsed, 201 of them, rather than dated wrongly. Book III rules nothing and is read for the sale sentence, «6000 - 1/3 = 4000. Feb. 17», and nothing else. Where a row states a price, a rate and a receipt, the receipt is checked against price less commission; a disagreement is reported and never corrected. A sale written into two volumes is matched on title, price and rate and counted once, and the collapse is published so it can be argued with. A party is credited on its name or surname; two spellings merge only where one's words sit inside the other's, the remaining merges are declared by hand in an aliases file, and a bare surname shared by two declared parties is reported ambiguous and credited to nobody. Money is kept in three buckets, collected, still owed and not recorded, and the script asserts at every level that they sum to the accrual.

The Book IV reader is the more consequential and its rules are set out in `docs/book-iv-method.md`, period by period, because the writer's method changes four times. Items are the charge; a «bill» counts only where nothing was itemised since the last settlement, or every commission in the volume would be counted twice. A bare figure is a subtotal where a bill, a «less» line or a carried total follows it, or where a cheque follows it and the priced lines above add to it; the leaf rules a line above a subtotal and the transcription does not record the rule, so the rule is recovered from the arithmetic.

A «less» line is a deduction whichever thing it names. What stands between it and the cheque is the net restated. A red receipt rubbed out and rewritten is counted once. A title charged more than once, where one entry says on account or balance, is one picture at the largest figure and the others are reported as instalments. The year is carried from the last one the volume states, and it carries across a batch boundary only where the batches abut. Receipts are kept as their own stream, because a cheque settles a run of work and the runs overlap. The check on all of it is the book's own pencil totals, and the reader's receipts reconcile to them to the cent wherever the leaf's arithmetic closes.

Two of these rules were found by bugs. An unanchored match on the word *bill* took a story title, «Wild Bill in Deadwood Gulch», for an invoice and lost a drawing of 1915; a header rule read «May 25th Initial Letters» as a new client and counted an Adventure bill of 225 twice. Both were caught by checking the per-year totals against leaves read by hand, and the method note records that a faithful transcription can surface a reader bug without containing one.

8.6 *The ink pass*

Book IV's colour is its status field, and fourteen batches were transcribed without recording it. `scripts/ink.mjs` reads the colour off the photographs, because «the colour is the one thing on the leaf a machine can see better than the hand it is written in»: it aligns each leaf's transcribed rows with the written lines of its image, classifies each money cell as black, red or pencil, and writes the result into `\ink{}` and `\ruledoff` where the transcriber accepts it. Where it has run, twelve leaves so far, red money is a receipt and pencil money a sum before any word is read. It also found, on leaf 21, a whole entry the transcription lacked, and it reports seventy-four leaves with at least one written line the transcription does not have, which is the worklist for the re-reading pass.

That figure needs stating for what it is, because it bears on this note and not only on the accounts. The ink pass has run on Book IV alone, so the seventy-four leaves are Book IV leaves, about half of that volume; many of the lines it flags are the alignment's own noise, and each has to be looked at, but at least one, the Country Gentleman entry of 26 February 1917 on leaf 21, was a real omission. The consequence for this note is bounded and can be said exactly. The Book IV chapter quotes the pocket book for its shape and its last leaves, and those quotations are of lines the transcription has, not of lines it lacks; what a missing line changes is a sum, so the figures of the cash book, Tables A.1 and A.2 and Figure 10.1, are floors in a second sense as well as the first: a leaf may hold a charge or a receipt the reader never saw. No such pass has run on the other five volumes or the notebooks, so nothing is known about their omissions, which is a different and larger uncertainty than a counted one. The quotations from Books I to III and from the notebooks in this note are readings of lines that exist on the sheet; whether a neighbouring line was skipped is not something any reading here can rule out.

8.7 *The rules, proved: two certificates in Lean*

A reader's rules written in prose and applied by a script can drift apart without anyone noticing, and a total can be right by accident. The last addition to the method, made

on 14 September 2026 after this note was first drafted, restates the accounts in the Lean theorem prover, so that the build fails if the script and its stated rules disagree. The proofs are in `lean/` in the repository, were written by Claude Opus 5 under Michel Hua's direction, and use nothing but Lean itself. Every figure in the ledgers is dollars and cents, and every commission is a third, a quarter, a tenth or fifteen per cent, so money is counted in sixtieths of a cent, in which all of them, including « $33\frac{2}{3}$ », are whole numbers and the arithmetic is exact. General lemmas are proved for every input; the data is checked by the kernel's own evaluation and never by compiled code, and a proof left unfinished counts as a failure of the build.

The first certificate concerns what the accounts publish about money. For each activity, painter and illustrator, it recomputes every published year from the rows, the running balance and the totals, and proves from the rows, rather than reading it off the totals, that what accrued equals what was collected plus what is still owed plus what was not recorded. It proves of the dealer's third, for every price, that the third truncated to the cent is never over the exact third and never under it by more than two thirds of a cent, so the reader's two-cent test passes every figure written to the cent and never a slip of a third of a dollar. It proves that of the ninety-five rows where a price, a rate and a written receipt stand together, ninety agree, and that the five that do not are the five the reader names. And it proves that, for each year whose pencil total is declared by hand, the receipts equal the total written on the leaf plus what the book is declared to leave out, to the cent.

The second certificate concerns the Book IV reader described two sections above. Its four passes (carrying the year and the title, dropping a doubtful figure the next row repeats plainly, deciding each figure's disposition, and collapsing instalments) are written as Lean functions, and the properties `docs/book-iv-method.md` asserts in prose are proved of them for every possible book, not only this one. A «bill» is charged only where nothing was itemised since the last settlement, so no commission is counted twice; a «less» line is never a charge, whatever state the reader is in; a bare figure is a subtotal exactly when the answering line or the arithmetic above says so; a receipt rubbed out on the net's row counts once; a picture charged more than once and paid in parts is charged once, at a figure no smaller than any instalment; the year does not carry across a gap between batches, and a figure without a year is reported unread. Then the kernel runs the functions over all 3,281 transcribed rows of the volume, which takes it about two and a half minutes, and proves that every row is decided exactly once and that the Lean reader keeps, classifies, dates and disposes of each one as `scripts/accounts.mjs` does, and that the counts the site publishes, 858 charges, 579 receipts, 124 deductions and the rest, are counts of those decisions. Changing a single disposition in the data makes the build fail, which was tried.

Writing the rules as functions sharpened them in one place and explained a defect in another. The prose said that a «less» line is a deduction whichever thing it names; the proof would not go through until the exception was stated, that a «less» line which is also a ditto directly under a receipt reads as that receipt. And the year 1921, which the accounts chapter notes is missing from the cash book, is now a theorem: the year line on leaf 53 reads 1920 over entries of 1921, the next year line reads 1922, every row between them is booked under 1920 and none under 1921. The rule is applied as written; the defect is the line, and the theorem is meant to fail on the day the line is corrected at source.

What the certificates do not prove must be said as plainly, because the word *proved*

invites more trust than it earns. They do not touch a reading: whether a leaf says « 16.66 » is a question for the photograph, and a figure misread consistently in the rows and in the sums would pass. They do not prove the regular expressions that recognise what a row's words are, « rec'd by check », « bill », « less », a ditto; those arrive as data, and only what is decided from them is proved. And they prove that the script agrees with the stated rules, not that the rules are the right reading of Josephine Hopper's method; that remains an argument, made in the method note, to be had with the leaves. Two further formalisations, of the leaf and page numberings and of the conversion to TEI, are tracked as issue 28. The certificates are checked on every push by the same workflow that builds the site, and a configuration for GitLab's continuous integration runs the same two steps.

8.8 The working method: a person, two models, a repository and an interface

The pipeline above was not bought and was not assembled from a transcription service. It was built by one person, Michel Hua, over a fortnight in September 2026, and the way it was built is itself part of the method, because it is what makes the reading checkable.

Claude as the reader

The transcriptions were made with Claude Code, Anthropic's command-line agent, running the models Claude Opus 5 and Claude Fable 5.1. The work is packaged as skills, small instruction files kept in the repository under `.claude/skills/`: `transcribe-hopper` reads a batch of twelve sheets into the restricted LaTeX and writes its header; `tag-hopper` writes the keywords line that closes a transcription; `modernize-hopper` writes the per-work notes from named museum sources only. The skills accept Fable 5.1, Fable 5 or Opus 5 and refuse any other model, and every file records which one read its sheets and on what day, so that a batch's provenance is a fact about the file and not about whichever model happened to be selected. Opus 5 read most of the ledgers between 5 and 12 September; Fable 5.1 read the last sittings of the black notebook and the Battle of Wash Sq. on 10 and 13 September, and drafted this note. The model does what a first transcriber does and no more: it reads what it can, marks what it cannot, attributes hands cautiously, and writes a note where a decision was made. It does not check itself, and the edition does not pretend it did.

GitHub as the workbench

The repository on GitHub is the record of the work and the place it is done. Every batch, every script and every correction is a commit on the main branch, and the issue tracker holds the open questions as numbered issues with a plain convention, a « [P1] » in the title meaning that the issue blocks the edition: the ink of Book IV, the Zenodo deposit, the per-file revision history a citation will one day need. The continuous integration workflow described above runs on every push and refuses a push whose generated files have drifted from their sources, and the same workflow builds and deploys the site to GitHub Pages under the project's own domain. Nothing about the edition lives on a machine of its author's: a clone of the repository is the edition entire, minus the photographs, which are the

museum's.

An interface built for the purpose

The site at hopper.commutator.io was written by Michel Hua for this project, and it does one thing that no general-purpose tool did: it puts the transcription beside the Whitney's own photograph of the sheet, so that scrolling the reading turns the photograph and a doubtful figure can be checked against the hand it came out of on one screen. Everything else on it follows from that. The reading view offers a Cite button that builds the three citations, sheet, leaf and batch, from what the page already knows; the Accounts, Technique, Timeline and Schema tabs are the derived files rendered, with the rules that produced them printed beside the figures; the Diaries side serves the four notebooks the same way. The interface is the checking instrument. A machine reading that could not be put beside its source would be a text nobody could correct, and the whole value of the transcription is that it can be.

Working in parallel: Claude Code and remote control

A corpus of five hundred sheets is not read in one sitting, and it was not read in one session. Claude Code runs as a local session on the author's machine, and several sessions can run at once: one transcribing a batch of Book IV while another reads the ink off its photographs, another writes the accounts reader and a fourth builds a page of the site to show the result. Each session has its own context, which is what the skill demands of a batch, and each leaves its work as a commit the others pull. Claude Code's remote control lets those sessions be started, directed and followed from another device, so that the machine at 3 Washington Square North's equivalent, a desk in one place, keeps working while its owner is elsewhere and answers a question from a telephone. That is an interesting way to work for a reason that has nothing to do with convenience: it makes the parallelism explicit. A transcription pass and an analysis pass over the same leaves are different jobs with different rules, and running them as different sessions, each with its own instructions and its own commit, keeps them from contaminating each other in the way a single long conversation would. This note was made the same way: eight readings of the transcripts ran at once, one per volume or notebook, and the prose was written from their reports.

8.9 *What this note added, and how*

This note was written in one session on 13 September 2026. Eight readings of the transcripts were run in parallel, one per volume or notebook, each instructed to read its files whole and return the structure, the quotable passages exactly as transcribed with leaf and reference, the hard data, the hands, and the transcriber's notes; the dealers' book was read in two passes when its first reading found only a quarter of the leaves. The tables in the appendix were generated by a small script from the edition's derived files and are reproducible from them. The prose was then written from those readings and from the derived data, chapter by chapter, and compiled with Tectonic. Nothing in it was checked against a photograph. Where the readings disagreed with a batch header, both are reported; where a reading found a defect in the transcription, it is listed for correction at source and not

corrected here, on the edition's own rule that a corrected reading goes to the .tex with the name of who checked it.

That is the chain. The photograph is the museum's; the harvest is a person's; the transcription is a model's, first pass, dated; the derived files are scripts', with their rules published and their failures loud; the note is a model's again. Every link can be inspected, and the weakest one, the unchecked reading, is the one every sentence here says it rests on.

What the pictures were made of, and what shape

9.1 *The formula*

From Book II onward nearly every oil leaf carries, under the title, a short block naming the colourman, the canvas and its priming, the white, the oil and the thinner, in that order and in the same words for thirty years. Of 270 work headings in the transcribed leaves, 77 carry a formula. It is the only surviving statement of what was on the palette on a given day, and it is not a measurement of an object or a report of an event: it is, as the edition's technique page says, «her hand recording his practice».

The materials, counted once per work and with spellings folded (Chremnitz, Cremnitz and Crimnitz are one white; Winsor and Windsor one colourman; turpentine, tarptentine and terptentine one bottle), fall into six groups. The colourmen: Rembrandt on seventeen works, all in Book II and all around 1932; Blockx on eighteen, 1939 to 1949; Winsor & Newton on fifty-five, 1939 to 1964; Grumbacher once, for a canvas in 1944. The whites: zinc white on nineteen works, 1929–32; lead white on twelve, 1943–57; flake white on thirty, 1944–64; silver white on eight, around 1949, which she once glosses «Blockx Silver (lead) White»; Chremnitz white on nine, 1952–56. The oils: poppy on twenty-six works, 1932–44; linseed on forty-five, 1943–64; the leaves never remark on the change. Turpentine on forty. The canvas makers: Winton on eight, Fornet (or Foinet) on two, «(National)» on twelve between 1949 and 1955, Herga on ten from 1956 to 1963. The priming: double on nineteen works to 1955, single on thirteen from 1949. Table A.8 in the appendix gives the counts.

Put together, the formulae make a chronology of practice that the leaves state and nobody has stated for them. In 1932: «Rembrandt, zinc white, poppy oil», fourteen works. In 1937–38: «Rembrandt colors, lead white, linseed oil» on Belgian canvas. From 1939: Winsor & Newton with Blockx, silver or zinc white, poppy oil, on Winton or Belgian double prime. From 1943 to 1948: Winsor & Newton, flake white, linseed oil, turpentine. From 1949 to 1951: the same on «(National)» double prime. From 1952 to 1955: Chremnitz white in place of flake, still on National double prime. From 1956: Herga canvas, single prime, flake white again, and, under the last picture, lead white. The one dated change in the whole sequence is the colourman, and the Provincetown diary supplies the date: on 18 May 1938, «E. wants to change over to Windsor Newton oils — So I'm to inherit gold Rembrandt colors.» The ledgers show the change a leaf later, on New York Movie in January 1939, «Winton canvas, Winsor & Newton colors. — 1st lead white and linseed oil. 2nd Zinc white» (Book II, leaf 27, ref 16621). The leaf also shows what a formula can carry that a list cannot: two whites on one picture, the second over the first.

Two things should be said against reading too much into this. The formula is present on only seventy-seven works, and a work is dated by it only where she wrote «Painted in ...» in the same statement or he put the year in the title line, so that the chronology rests on forty-three dated works and not on all of them. And what the leaf says is what she wrote, which is what he told her or what she saw on the table; «Colors and canvas unknown, probably zinc white» under November, Washington Square (Book III, leaf 67, ref 16582) is the one admission of not knowing, and it concerns a canvas of 1932 whose sky was repainted in 1959. The formula is a record of a habit, not a laboratory report, and the two agree only as far as the habit was regular. It was very regular.

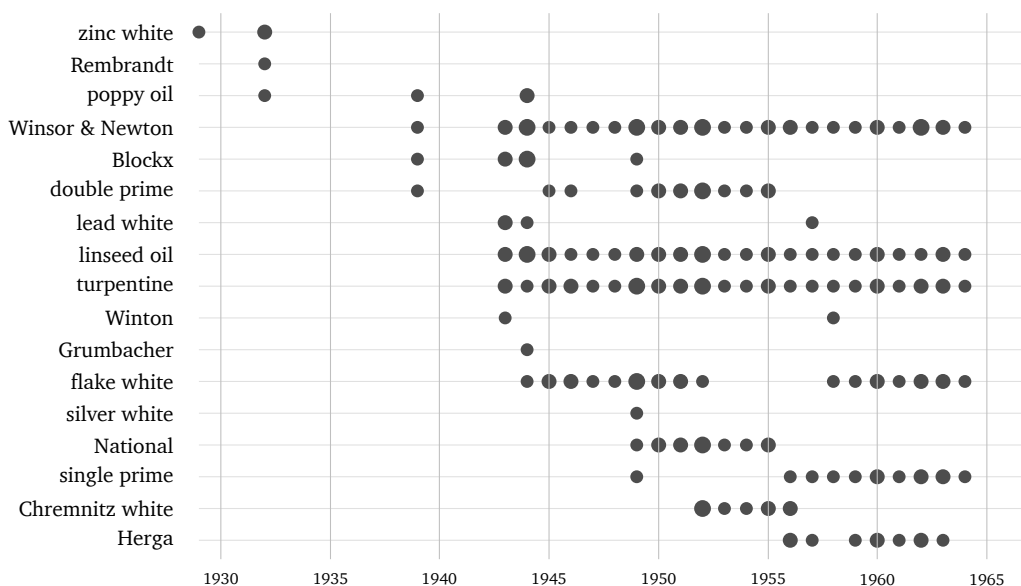


Figure 9.1: A succession, not a preference: each material against the years the leaves date it to, earliest first, one dot to a year and its size standing for how many works that year names it. Rembrandt colours and zinc white in poppy oil at the start; Winsor & Newton and flake white in linseed oil and turpentine from the middle 1940s; the canvas turning from National to Herga and the priming from double to single across the 1950s. Only the 43 works dated by the leaf itself are plotted. After the Technique tab. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from `materials.json` (undated).

9.2 The size

The size in the title line is the one figure in the archive Edward Hopper wrote himself, and it is the only quantity that measures an object rather than reporting an event. Read from the headings only, 199 of 270 carry a size, and they make 78 formats: 72 landscape, 6 portrait, none square. Thirty-four formats recur; forty-four occur once. Nothing is rounded, so 23 1/2 by 28 and 23 1/2 by 28 3/4 are two formats because they are two things he wrote.

The recurring formats are the watercolour sheets. Twenty-two works at 20 by 28 and twenty at 14 by 20, the whole and the half of the imperial sheet, are the Cape and Vermont watercolours of Books II and III: Cobb House, Longnook Valley, Mouth of Pamet, White River at Sharon, Oregon Coast, Jo in Wyoming. Nine at 12 by 18 are the Gloucester drawings of Book V. The oils cluster differently. Seven at 24 by 29 are the early canvases of

Book I, Corner Saloon, House by a Railroad, Sailing, Moonlight Interior; six at $23\frac{1}{2}$ by $28\frac{3}{4}$ are the Paris oils. Seven at 28 by 40 are the studio pictures of 1949 to 1954, High Noon, Conference at Night, Morning Sun, Portrait of Orleans, Office in a Small City; six at 30 by 40 are 7 A.M., Sea Watchers, South Carolina Morning, Excursion into Philosophy, Sunlight on Brownstones, Two Puritans; four at 29 by 40 are Light House Hill, Rooms by the Sea, Sun in an Empty Room and Ex Lax, a format he used in 1927 and again in 1963; and four at 40 by 60 are the largest pictures of the last decade, People in the Sun, Sunlight in a Cafeteria, A Woman in the Sun, Intermission. Nighthawks is alone at 33 by 60, and Blackwell's Island and Seventh Avenue Shops, which is Early Sunday Morning, share 35 by 60. The six portrait formats are all Mexican watercolours of 1943 and 1946, Saltillo Mansion, Monterrey Cathedral, the Sierra Madre, turned upright for the mountains.

What the sizes show, beyond the obvious, is that the museums' measurements and his agree to within the stretcher. The Metropolitan's *Tables for Ladies* is $48\frac{1}{4}$ by $60\frac{3}{8}$ against his «4 x 5 ft.»; the Art Institute's *Nighthawks* $33\frac{1}{8}$ by 60 against his 33 by 60; MoMA's *House by the Railroad* 24 by 29 to the inch. Where they do not agree, as with the *Des Moines Automat* at $28\frac{1}{8}$ by 35 against both ledgers' 28 by 36, the discrepancy is an inch, and the ledger is the earlier measurement.

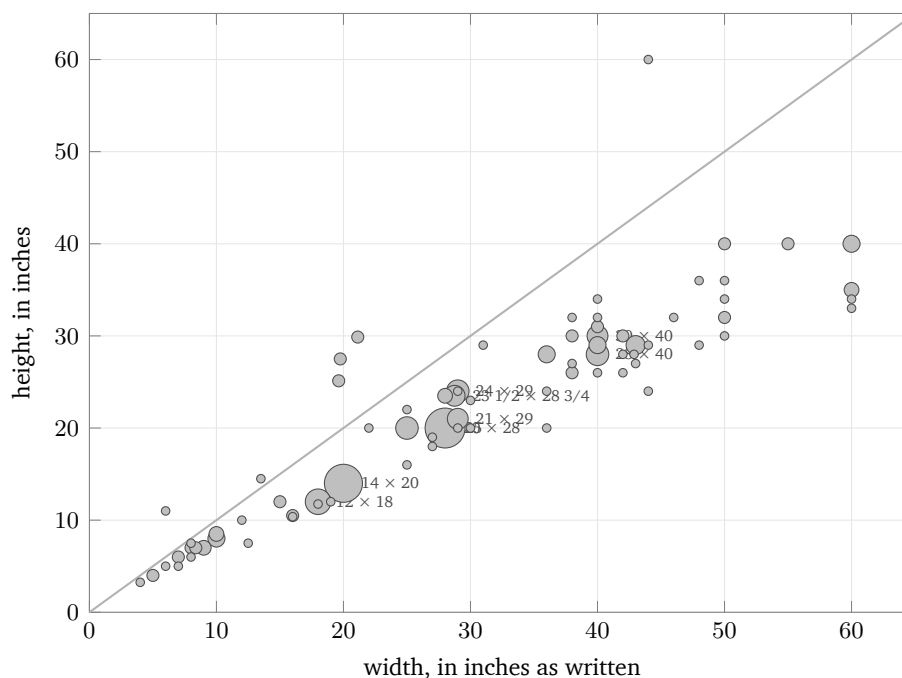


Figure 9.2: Every format, plotted: width across, height up, one dot to a format and its area standing for how many works were made at it, 78 formats from 199 work headings that state a size. The diagonal is where a picture would be square; 190 of the 199 works lie below it, 9 above, none on it. The etching plates are in the corner, the watercolour sheets through the middle, the late oils at the top right. After the Technique tab of hopper.commutator.io. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from `formats.json` (undated).

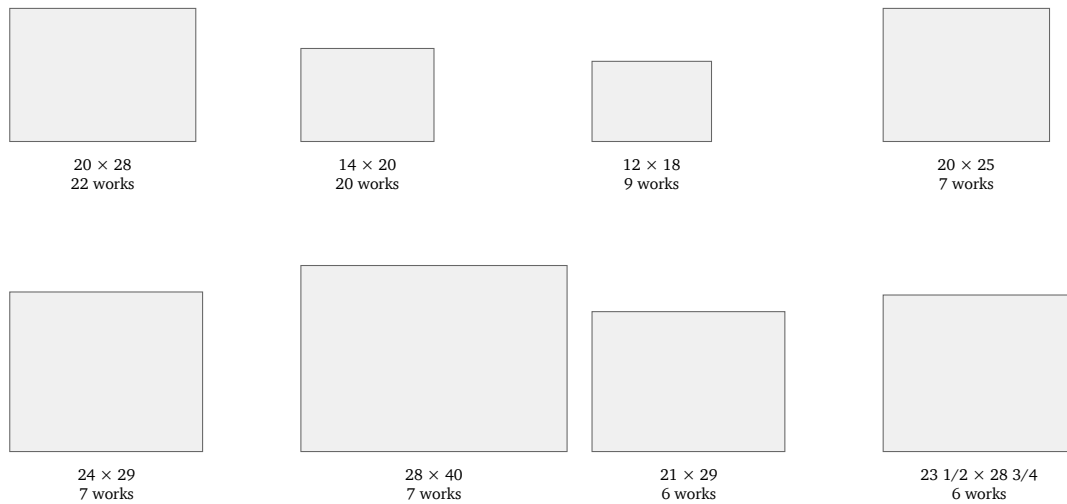


Figure 9.3: The eight formats he came back to, drawn to one scale and to their real proportions, so that a watercolour half-sheet stands beside a five-foot canvas; each is labelled with the number of work headings read at that size. After the Technique tab. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from `formats.json` (undated).

9.3 *The frames, from the other book*

The ledgers stop at the canvas. The black notebook goes on to the frame, and it does so for her pictures and not his, which is itself a fact about the household: the man whose canvases went to Rehn's was framed by the gallery, and the woman whose canvases hung in the rear studio bought her own frames from Burges-Revel of La Porte, Indiana, at \$21 to \$30.75 each, and wrote down which picture went in which. The Rehn frames appear in her lists as objects in the rack, «2 gold from Rehn Gal. 28 1/4 x 36 1/2», «Silver frame f/ Canvas from Rehn Gal. / 37 1/2 x 23 1/4 Canvas = 36 x 25», and in Book IV as deductions on the dealer's statement: «Frame for Dauphinee House -48 00», «Frame by Kulicke for "East River" 144 00». What she thought of frames on his pictures is in Book III: «Bad frame; insert same color as window curtain R., takes all force out of highest spot in canvas» under *A Woman in the Sun*, and, at the very end, «the only perfect frame ever worn by a Hopper canvas», on the same picture, secured by the woman who bought it.

The money, added up

10.1 *What can be counted, and what cannot*

The figures in this chapter are read out of the transcribed rows by a script whose rules are published with the edition, and they were generated on 11 September 2026 from 46 batches and 543 sheets. They are floors. Every leaf not yet transcribed contributes nothing, and every figure moves as batches land. Three limits are structural and should be stated before any number is.

First, the ruling. A row is counted only where the leaf puts the price in one cell and the date in another, because the column a date stands in is what says whether it dates the sale or the cheque. The etchings leaves of Book I date the exhibition in their first column and carry an impression's whole history on one line, so their sales have no date but the day the cheque cleared, and 201 rows are reported as unparsed rather than dated wrongly. Book III rules no columns and writes the sale as a sentence, «6000 - 1/3 = 4000. Feb. 17», and is read for that sentence and nothing else. Book V's money is on the sheets and in no total.

Second, the two trades. Books I, II, III and the dealers' book record Edward Hopper selling his own work; Book IV records him being paid for drawings and, from 1920, records the pictures again from the dealer's side. The three are kept apart. Adding the illustration income to the art would change every total without changing its label, and adding Book IV's cash to the work books' accruals would count most pictures twice.

Third, the three buckets. A sale is *collected* where its row states a receipt, *outstanding* where it states a receipt still to come, and *not recorded* where the row says nothing either way. Reading silence as debt would compare a silence with a sum. Book IV names a cheque for nearly every charge; the work books often name none.

10.2 *The illustrator, 1913–1925*

Table A.1 gives the illustration decade. Charged, 14,455.87 dollars over the thirteen calendar years from 1913 to 1925; received, 14,654.87; the balance negative by 199, because the book receipts money it never charged, the Shipping Board's three hundred for «Smash the Hun» being the largest instance. The best years are 1920, at 2950 charged, and 1917–18, at about 1500 each; the worst is 1915, at 500. There is no row for 1921, and the reason is on leaf 53 of the book: its year line reads «1920» above entries that are 1921's, the transcription keeps the line as written, and the reader carries the year from the last one the volume states, so 1921's income sits under 1920 in the table. It is the kind of defect the method is designed to expose rather than repair silently, and it is listed for correction at source. These are not large sums even for the time, and they are the whole of what

the paintings books do not mention. By 1925 the picture sales through Rehn, in the same pocket book, had passed them.

10.3 The painter, by the work books

Table A.3 gives the art side as the work books state it, year by year: sales counted, gross, commission, net, and what the rows say was receipted. The rows that can be read this way number 380, and they carry 270,914 dollars of net over forty-four years; 62,777 of it is receipted on the row, none is stated as outstanding, and 208,137 is not recorded, which is to say that Book II and Book III write one date to a sale and do not separate the day the work went out from the day the cheque came. Every art sale whose row states a receipt was eventually paid.

The curve is the career. A few hundred dollars a year to 1925; three to five thousand a year from 1926 to 1929; 12,252 net in 1930, the year of *Tables for Ladies* to the Metropolitan and *Early Sunday Morning* to the Whitney; then the Depression, 1765 in 1931, 920 in 1932, 57 in 1933; three or four thousand a year through the late 1930s and 1940s, with the shape depending on whether a museum bought; 9853 in 1954; 14,940 in 1956, 17,647 in 1957; 20,667 in 1962 and 21,000 in each of 1963 and 1964; 16,667 in 1966 for one picture. Ninety of ninety-five checkable rows reconcile receipt to price less commission to the cent; the five that do not are reported and not corrected. One sale, *Blackwell's Island*, is written into two volumes and counted once.

Table A.4 ranks the sales that name a work. Every one of the top ten is in Book III and dated 1959 or later; the eleventh, *Girlie Show*, is the Book II canvas of 1941 sold in 1961. The first sale above 3000 dollars is *Tables for Ladies* in 1930; the next is *Cape Cod Afternoon* in 1938; nothing else passes that figure until *Rooms for Tourists* in 1946. Table A.5 ranks the buyers the transcription tags as persons or collections, on the rows that name them: Charles Stein, the Huntington Hartford Foundation, Stephen Clark, the Metropolitan, the Whitney, the Carnegie, Mrs. Blanchard of the 1924 watercolours. Table A.6 gives the dealers by the rows that name them beside a price: Rehn first, Keppel most often, and Goodspeed's of Boston second by value on the strength of one canvas.

10.4 The painter, by the cash book

Table A.2 gives Book IV as a cash book for the pictures from 1920 to 1967, the charges the leaves itemise against the cheques they receipt. It is a different number from the work books' and it should be, because it is the dealer's statement and not the studio's record: 544,547 charged against 432,871 received over forty-seven years, the difference mostly the dealer's third and the instalments. Its shape agrees with the work books' where the two overlap and is fuller where they do not. The 1920s peak at 11,444 charged in 1928; the 1930s trough at 77 in 1933 and recover to 10,032 in 1938; the 1940s run between 1590 and 11,383; the 1950s climb from 4790 in 1950 to 39,457 in 1956; the 1960s reach 46,517 in 1962 and 47,982 in 1963, then 32,820, 25,100, 25,000, and 8100 in the year he died. The receipts, which are the figures her pencil sums check, run 40,218 in 1962 and 25,657 in 1963. In no year of his life did Edward Hopper's cheques from his dealer exceed forty-one thousand dollars, and in only nine years did they exceed twenty.

The reader knows what it cannot read. Fifty-eight subtotals, 124 deductions, 81 re-stated nets, 93 carried sums and six rubbed-out drafts are excluded by rule; five instalment sales are collapsed to one picture each; thirteen rows have no description. Where the year's pencil total closes, the receipts reconcile to the cent. Where the transcription and the leaf disagree, as on leaf 156, where the note reads the fore-edge total as 21,949 and the marginal as 21,944, the leaf needs re-reading and this chapter says so rather than choosing.

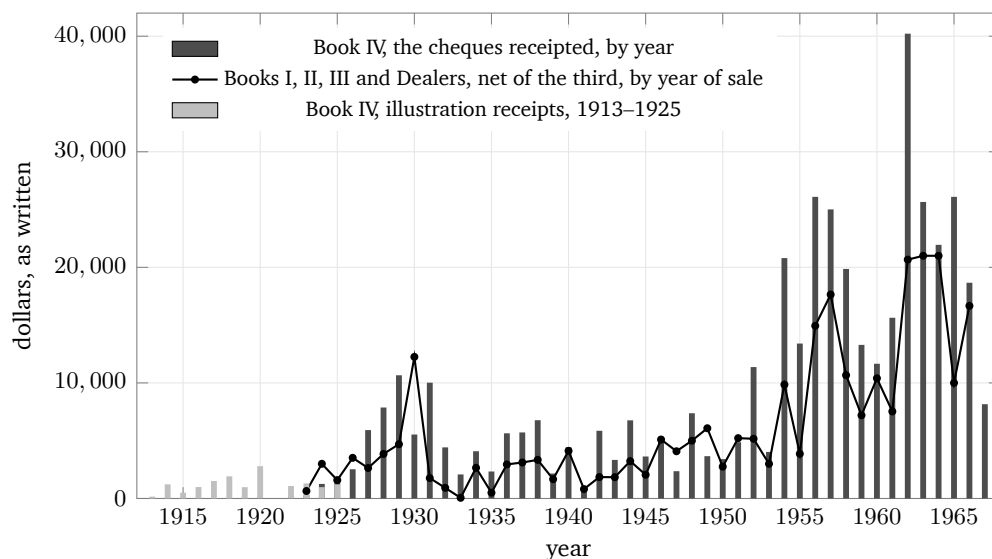


Figure 10.1: The money, three ways: what the pocket book receipts each year from 1920 (dark bars), what the work books state as the net of sales dated in that year (line), and the illustration receipts of the first decade (pale bars). The two art series are not the same number and should not be: one is the dealer's cheques as they arrived, the other the studio's record of what left. Every figure is a floor, read from the transcribed rows under the rules of the accounts chapter. After the Accounts tab of hopper.commutator.io. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from `accounts.json` (2026-09-11).

10.5 *The days the books were written on*

One more count, because it is about the record rather than the money. Of the rows in the six ledgers whose date resolves to a calendar day, 2146 fall on 1204 distinct days between 1913 and 1967; Book IV supplies 1287 of them, the dealers' book 478, Book I 358, and Book II, which writes one date to a sale, only two. The busiest day in the archive is 18 October 1929, with twenty-nine rows across Book I and the dealers' book, a Keppel and Kennedy settlement eleven days before the crash; the longest run of consecutive days is seven, 2 to 8 February 1929, the week of the second Rehn show. The rows fall on every day of the week but Sunday, which has 34 against about two hundred for each of the others; and they fall in every month, with a marked hollow in July, August and September, which is the Cape. Table A.9 gives the years. These are the days the books record a transaction, not the days anybody worked, and Josephine Hopper wrote almost all of them.

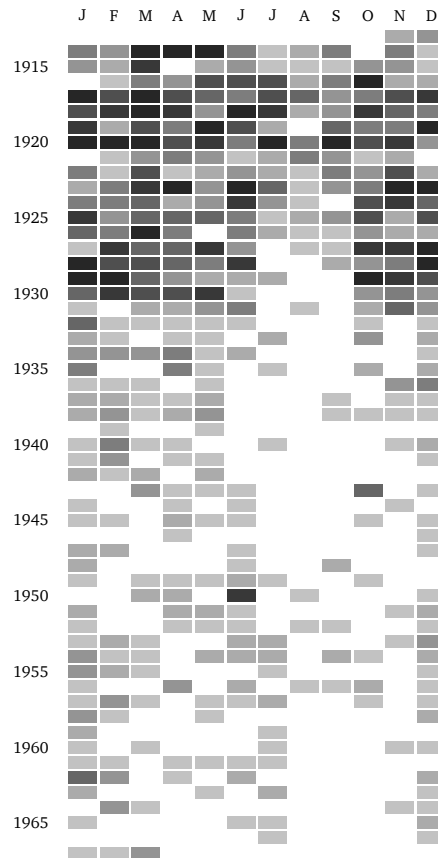


Figure 10.2: The days the six books record, one row to a year from 1913 to 1967 and one cell to a month, the darker the more days that month carry an entry: 1204 days in all, from 2146 dated rows. A dense cell is a month of transactions, not of painting; the hollow every summer is the Cape, with the dealers behind them in New York. By day of the week: Sun 34, Mon 197, Tue 197, Wed 179, Thu 215, Fri 207, Sat 175, Sunday a sixth of a weekday. After the calendar of the Timeline tab, which draws every day; this draws every month. Drawn by Claude Fable 5.1, 13 September 2026, from `streak.json` (2026-09-13).

Conclusion: the record and the silence

There are two ways to read these ten books, and the historian who uses them has to decide which one is being done at each sentence.

The first reads them as a source: for prices, dates, buyers, sizes, materials, exhibitions, the sequence of a career. Read that way they are very good and their limits are exactly known. They were kept at the time, by one person, from the cheque; their arithmetic closes; their dates agree with the museums' accession registers where those can be checked, and their measurements agree with the museums' rulers to the stretcher. Where they are wrong they are wrong in the ways a household record is wrong: a dealer's death dated two ways, a hearing dated the 18th and the 19th, a print charged to the wrong plate and corrected on the facing leaf, a name spelt as it sounded. Nothing in them was invented for effect, and the few places where she reconstructed the past from memory, the Armory Show sale at \$200, \$225 and \$250, are the places where the record says three things and can be seen to.

The second reads them as a document: as the work of Josephine Nivison Hopper, who was an actress and then a painter and then, for forty-three years, the keeper of another painter's books, and who wrote into those books, under his drawings, the sentences he would not say. Read that way the ledgers are continuous with the notebooks, and the anecdotes under the paintings, «Shirley» and «Olga» and «Nora» and «man night hawk (beek)», are the trace of a writer who had been given one column to write in and used it. Her descriptions have been quoted by every writer on Hopper since Levin, and usually as evidence of what the pictures are about. They are evidence of what she thought worth recording on the day the picture left the studio, and the notebooks show, with some bitterness, that what she recorded of his was what nobody was recording of hers.

One of the quietest facts in the archive says the same thing from the other side: the only frames priced anywhere in the ten books are the ones Josephine Hopper bought for her own canvases, from a maker in Indiana, and wrote down in the notebook she headed «Her book»; his were the gallery's, and they appear in the ledgers as deductions on the dealer's statement.

The silence that the books surround is his. In fifty-four years of Book IV the hand that kept it wrote no sentence that was not a charge, a receipt or a sum. In the three work books his contribution is a drawing, a title and a size. The two sentences of his purpose that the archive preserves are both reported by her: a favourite line of Goethe's, «strictly off the record», and «the arrestation of a moment in time - with the most acute realization», extracted, as she put it, by cruelly pinning him down. Everything else that has been written about what Edward Hopper meant has been written against that silence, and much of it has been written from her sentences without saying so.

What the edition adds is not a fact but a condition: that every sentence quoted here can be checked against the photograph of the leaf it came from, on one screen, by anybody. The reading is first-pass, unchecked, and dated; its errors will be found; the address of the

sheet will not move when they are. That is the right state for a source like this to be in. The books were kept so that someone would read them. The inside cover of Book I says who wrote them and who drew in them, and the notebooks say what it cost. The rest is on the leaves.

Appendix A

Tables

The tables below were generated from the edition's derived files (the accounts, formats, materials and streak files under `src/content`) as they stood on 13 September 2026, themselves built from 46 transcribed batches. Every figure is a reading of a transcribed row under a stated rule, and every one is a floor that moves as batches are transcribed and readings corrected. Sums are in dollars as written on the leaves; nothing is adjusted for the value of money.

Table A.1: Book IV, the illustration decade: what was charged and what was received, by year, as the transcribed leaves state it. Accrual at the leaf's own date column; a negative balance is a cheque with no charge line behind it. There is no row for 1921 because leaf 53's year line reads 1920 above entries of 1921 and the reader keeps the year as written; that year's income is counted under 1920.

Year	Charged	Received	Balance
1913	160.00	160.00	0.00
1914	1,225.00	1,225.00	0.00
1915	500.00	500.00	0.00
1916	991.00	991.00	0.00
1917	1,509.00	1,514.00	-5.00
1918	1,556.00	1,916.00	-365.00
1919	977.00	977.00	-365.00
1920	2,950.00	2,794.00	-209.00
1922	1,075.00	1,075.00	-209.00
1923	1,279.20	1,304.20	-234.00
1924	1,015.00	980.00	-199.00
1925	1,218.67	1,218.67	-199.00
Total	14,455.87	14,654.87	-199.00

Table A.2: Book IV as a cash book for the pictures, 1920–1967: the charges the leaves itemise and the cheques they receipt, by year. The running balance is charged less received, cumulative; it is not a debt but the gap between what the gallery listed and what its cheques carried, most of it the dealer's third.

Year	Charged	Received	Running balance
1920	71.00	71.00	0.00
1922	141.00	141.00	0.00
1923	326.20	301.20	25.00
1924	1,360.10	1,260.10	125.00
1925	1,528.36	1,528.34	125.02
1926	2,523.49	2,528.49	120.02

Year	Charged	Received	Running balance
1927	3,992.71	5,918.08	-1,805.35
1928	11,444.02	7,870.68	1,767.99
1929	10,660.86	10,661.36	1,767.49
1930	5,513.41	5,533.41	1,747.49
1931	5,829.18	10,018.75	-2,442.08
1932	2,104.50	4,421.84	-4,759.42
1933	76.66	2,081.00	-6,763.76
1934	4,087.00	4,087.00	-6,763.76
1935	609.00	2,334.46	-8,489.22
1936	2,614.76	5,639.91	-11,514.37
1937	6,983.34	5,714.27	-10,245.30
1938	10,031.84	6,771.05	-6,984.51
1939	3,250.00	2,160.47	-5,894.98
1940	6,699.82	4,438.16	-3,633.32
1941	1,590.00	874.60	-2,917.92
1942	8,430.00	5,857.44	-345.36
1943	4,922.83	3,338.37	1,239.10
1944	10,455.00	6,761.77	4,932.33
1945	4,725.06	3,632.18	6,025.21
1946	8,050.00	5,341.57	8,733.64
1947	3,520.53	2,360.53	9,893.64
1948	11,383.49	7,374.54	13,902.59
1949	9,026.80	3,661.14	19,268.25
1950	4,790.00	3,408.49	20,649.76
1951	4,870.00	4,870.00	20,649.76
1952	15,625.25	11,371.03	24,903.98
1953	4,147.77	4,029.07	25,022.68
1954	31,213.48	20,799.82	35,436.34
1955	9,262.20	13,406.39	31,292.15
1956	39,457.13	26,098.61	44,650.67
1957	25,013.08	25,013.08	44,650.67
1958	29,687.53	19,861.37	54,476.83
1959	20,047.73	13,289.92	61,234.64
1960	17,040.73	11,657.24	66,618.13
1961	15,922.20	15,637.21	66,903.12
1962	46,516.97	40,217.56	73,202.53
1963	47,981.83	25,657.16	95,527.20
1964	32,819.98	21,947.98	106,399.20
1965	25,100.00	26,100.00	105,399.20
1966	25,000.00	18,666.67	111,732.53
1967	8,100.00	8,157.06	111,675.47
Total	544,546.84	432,871.37	111,675.47

Table A.3: The work books (Books I, II, III and Dealers/Etchings): sales dated in the leaf's own date column, by year. Gross is the price written; the commission is the dealer's share as the row states it; net is what was left. Only rows that put a price in one cell and a date in another are counted, so the etchings are largely absent.

Year	Sales	Gross	Commission	Net	Received
1923	3	970	323	647	0
1924	6	4,500	1,500	3,000	0
1925	4	2,100	510	1,590	340
1926	11	5,275	1,758	3,517	850
1927	17	3,955	1,318	2,637	1,333
1928	24	5,774	1,919	3,855	1,197
1929	52	7,040	2,342	4,698	4,197
1930	34	18,378	6,126	12,252	3,000
1931	17	2,648	883	1,765	5,600
1932	3	1,380	460	920	2,400
1933	3	85	28	57	20
1934	14	3,980	1,327	2,653	800
1935	1	750	250	500	500
1936	6	4,420	1,473	2,947	267
1937	10	4,670	1,557	3,113	20
1938	11	4,990	1,648	3,342	0
1939	1	2,500	833	1,667	0
1940	14	6,182	2,061	4,121	667
1941	4	1,220	407	813	267
1942	3	2,780	927	1,853	0
1943	4	2,760	920	1,840	1,200
1944	5	4,850	1,617	3,233	0
1945	5	3,080	1,027	2,053	0
1946	6	7,650	2,550	5,100	2,267
1947	7	6,130	2,043	4,087	1,467
1948	4	7,500	2,500	5,000	1,500
1949	5	9,115	3,038	6,077	0
1950	12	4,130	1,377	2,753	1,053
1951	11	7,830	2,610	5,220	333
1952	3	7,750	2,583	5,167	2,667
1953	9	4,500	1,500	3,000	500
1954	6	14,780	4,927	9,853	0
1955	6	5,800	1,933	3,867	2,333
1956	12	22,410	7,470	14,940	5,867
1957	19	26,470	8,823	17,647	667
1958	3	16,000	5,333	10,667	1,800
1959	2	10,800	3,600	7,200	6,000
1960	4	15,600	5,200	10,400	0
1961	10	11,295	3,765	7,530	0
1962	3	31,000	10,333	20,667	3,667

Year	Sales	Gross	Commission	Net	Receipted
1963	2	31,500	10,500	21,000	0
1964	2	31,500	10,500	21,000	0
1965	1	15,000	5,000	10,000	10,000
1966	1	25,000	8,333	16,667	0

Table A.4: The thirty sales at the highest prices among the rows that name a work, as the work books write them. Gross is the price; net is after the third.

Work	Price	Net	Year	Volume
Intermission	25,000	16,667	1966	III
Sun in an Empty Room	25,000	16,667	1964	III
New York Office	16,500	11,000	1963	III
People in the Sun	15,000	10,000	1962	III
A Woman in the Sun	15,000	10,000	1963	III
East River	15,000	10,000	1965	III
Excursion into Philosophy	14,500	9,667	1962	III
« Girlie Show »	11,000	7,333	1961	II
November, Wash. Square	10,000	6,667	1960	III
Sunlight in a Cafeteria	9,000	6,000	1959	III
Hotel Window	7,000	4,667	1957	III
Western Motel	6,500	4,333	1958	III
Charleston Slum	6,500	4,333	1964	III
Morning in a City	6,000	4,000	1949	III
Four Lane Road	6,000	4,000	1957	III
Dauphinée House	5,000	3,333	1956	II
Sunlight on Brownstones	5,000	3,333	1958	III
Tables for Ladies	4,500	3,000	1930	I
Men, Women + Horses	4,500	3,000	1958	II
Sea Watchers	4,500	3,000	1956	III
South Carolina Morning	4,500	3,000	1957	III
Cape Cod Morning	4,050	2,700	1956	III
« Bootleggers »	4,000	2,667	1956	II
Rooms by the Sea	4,000	2,667	1952	III
The Martha McKeen of Wellfleet	3,500	2,333	1954	III
Portrait of Orleans	3,500	2,333	1953	III
First Row Orchestra	3,500	2,333	1954	III
Morning Sun	3,500	2,333	1954	III
Hotel by a Railroad	3,500	2,333	1954	III
City Sunlight	3,500	2,333	1955	III

Table A.5: Buyers, ranked by the net the rows credit to them, among parties the transcription tags as a person or a collection. A row is credited on the name or the surname; a bare surname shared by two parties is reported ambiguous and credited to nobody.

Buyer	Sales	Gross	Net	Years
Charles Stein	4	15,400	10,267	1930–1961
Huntington Hartford Foundation	1	5,000	3,333	1956
Stephen C. Clark	5	4,700	3,133	1928–1944
Metropolitan Museum of Art	1	4,500	3,000	1930
Whitney Museum of American Art	3	3,450	2,300	1934–1957
Carnegie Institute	1	3,000	2,000	1938
Mrs. John Osgord Blanchard	3	2,550	1,700	1926–1930
Randolph Macon Women's College	1	2,500	1,667	1936
Charles MacArthur	1	2,500	1,667	1940
Laurence Fleishman	1	2,300	1,533	1960
Mrs. Bliss Parkinson	6	2,040	1,360	1930–1957
Alfredo Valente	1	2,000	1,333	1926
Cleveland Museum	1	2,000	1,333	1930
Mrs. Otto Spaeth	1	2,000	1,333	1942
Museum of Modern Art	1	1,800	1,200	1943
Leslie Green Sheaffer	4	1,750	1,167	1928–1930
Wadsworth Atheneum	3	1,550	1,033	1930–1934
John Taylor Spaulding	1	1,500	1,000	1927
Butler Institute of American Art	1	1,500	1,000	1948
Lloyd Goodrich	2	1,400	933	1937–1949
Fred Palmer	3	1,350	900	1931–1956
Harry Clark Bentley	2	1,150	767	1934–1938
Clifford Frondel	2	1,150	767	1950
Edward G. Robinson	1	1,000	667	1940
Newark Museum	1	900	600	1940
Lawrence Bloedel	1	900	600	1925
Charles E. Buckley	1	800	533	1926
Fogg Art Museum	1	750	500	1934

Table A.6: Dealers, by the rows that name them beside a price in the work books. Book IV's Rehn cheques are not in this table.

Dealer	Sales	Gross	Net	Years
Frank K. M. Rehn	42	5,456	3,637	1926–1957
Goodspeed's Book Shop	4	4,055	2,703	1924–1934
Frederick Keppel	58	1,465	977	1927–1940
Weyhe Gallery	19	1,248	832	1928–1941
Macbeth Gallery	2	1,200	800	1924–1957
Kennedy Galleries	21	665	443	1928–1957
John Clancy	1	600	400	1924
H. V. Allison	13	415	277	1943–1961
Downtown Gallery	6	151	101	1928–1931
Milch Galleries	3	78	52	1929
Babcock Art Galleries	2	60	40	1930

Table A.7: The sizes Edward Hopper wrote in the title line, counted once per work heading: the twenty formats that recur. Height before width, as he wrote them; nothing is rounded.

Format (in.)	Works	Examples
20 × 28	22	4 Dead Trees; Cape Cod Bay; Capron House
14 × 20	20	Back of freight Station; Bob Slater's Hill; Cape Elizabeth Shore
12 × 18	9	Double House, Gloucester; Gloucester Beach - Bass Rocks; Gloucester Boats at wharf
20 × 25	7	Cold Storage Plant; First Branch of White River; House on Pamet River
24 × 29	7	Corner Saloon; House by a Railroad; Moonlight Interior
28 × 40	7	City Sunlight; Conference at Night; High Noon
21 × 29	6	"El Palacio" (movie) Saltillo; California Hills; Cliffs near Mitla, Oaxaca
23 1/2 × 28 3/4	6	Après Midi de Juin; Ecluse de La Monnaie; Ile Saint Louis
30 × 40	6	7 A.M.; Excursion into Philosophy; Sea Watchers
29 × 43	5	Coast Guard Station at Two Lights & beach; Corn Hill, Truro; Light House at Two Lights
8 × 10	4	East Side Interior; The Cat Boat; The Lonely House
28 × 36	4	Capt. Ed Staples; Capt. Upton's House; Hodgkin's House
29 × 40	4	Ex Lax; Light House Hill; Rooms by the Sea
40 × 60	4	A Woman in the Sun; Intermission; People in the Sun
7 × 9	3	Girl on a Bridge; Railroad Crossing - drypoint; The Monhegan Boat
8 1/2 × 10	3	Les Deux Pigeon; Summer Twilight; Train & Bathers
23 1/2 × 28	3	Le Pont Royal; Le Quai des Grands Augustins; Notre Dame de Paris
35 × 60	3	7" Ave. Shops; Blackwell's Island
4 × 5	2	Don Quixote; Tables for Ladies
6 × 7	2	Bay Window; Les Poilhus

Table A.8: The paint formula as the leaves state it, counted once per work: 77 of 270 work headings carry one. Years are the first and last a dated formula names the material.

Group	Material	Works	Years
Colourmen	Winsor & Newton	55	1939–1964
Colourmen	Blockx	18	1939–1949
Colourmen	Rembrandt	17	1932–1932
Colourmen	Grumbacher	1	1944–1944
Whites	flake white	30	1944–1964
Whites	zinc white	19	1929–1932
Whites	lead white	12	1943–1957
Whites	Chremnitz white	9	1952–1956
Whites	silver white	8	1949–1949
Oils	linseed oil	45	1943–1964
Oils	poppy oil	26	1932–1944
Thinners	turpentine	40	1943–1964
Canvas makers and grades	National	12	1949–1955
Canvas makers and grades	Herga	10	1956–1963
Canvas makers and grades	Winton	8	1943–1958
Canvas makers and grades	Fornet	2	undated
Priming	double prime	19	1939–1955
Priming	single prime	13	1949–1964

Table A.9: Days on which the six ledgers record a transaction, and rows dated, by year: 2146 rows resolve to 1204 calendar days between 1913 and 1967.

Year	Days	Rows	Year	Days	Rows	Year	Days	Rows
1913	5	6	1932	12	21	1951	10	25
1914	48	55	1933	12	17	1952	7	10
1915	27	29	1934	17	48	1953	12	23
1916	44	46	1935	14	17	1954	16	24
1917	74	81	1936	11	24	1955	8	15
1918	69	83	1937	11	20	1956	11	24
1919	56	64	1938	15	40	1957	11	41
1920	86	102	1939	2	3	1958	7	12
1921	24	32	1940	11	34	1959	3	6
1922	35	47	1941	7	8	1960	5	12
1923	65	94	1942	7	11	1961	6	25
1924	47	72	1943	12	21	1962	13	20
1925	49	79	1944	4	8	1963	6	9
1926	36	92	1945	8	16	1964	6	9
1927	54	164	1946	2	4	1965	5	7
1928	59	138	1947	6	11	1966	2	3
1929	51	189	1948	5	9	1967	5	7
1930	42	90	1949	8	17			
1931	23	55	1950	13	27			

Sources

The objects

Josephine Nivison Hopper and Edward Hopper, *Artist's ledger — Book I*, 1913–1963. Whitney Museum of American Art, 96.208. Gift of Lloyd Goodrich. 117 digitised sheets.

Josephine Nivison Hopper and Edward Hopper, *Artist's ledger — Book II*, 1907–1962. Whitney Museum of American Art, 96.209. Gift of Lloyd Goodrich. 72 sheets.

Josephine Nivison Hopper and Edward Hopper, *Artist's ledger — Book III*, 1924–1967. Whitney Museum of American Art, 96.210. Gift of Lloyd Goodrich. 90 sheets.

Artist's ledger — Book IV, 1913–1967. Whitney Museum of American Art, 96.211. Purchase. 161 sheets. Hand unattributed.

Josephine Nivison Hopper and Edward Hopper, *Artist's ledger — Book V*, 1953–1963. Whitney Museum of American Art, 96.212. Gift of Lloyd Goodrich. 16 sheets.

Josephine Nivison Hopper, *Artist's ledger — Dealers/Etchings*, 1921–1951 (contents 1913–1961). Whitney Museum of American Art, 96.213. Purchase, with funds from an anonymous donor. 48 sheets.

Josephine Nivison Hopper, *Garrulities + Grouch* (1924–1950, contents to 1959), 42 sheets; *Re: 3 Wash Sq* (1947), 51 sheets; *Battle of Wash Sq.* (1947, contents to 1955), EJHA.1597, 8 sheets; black two-ring notebook (circa 1952–1961, contents 1937–1964), 68 sheets. Whitney Museum of American Art, Sanborn Hopper Archive, Series IV, Subseries A.

Josephine Nivison Hopper, diaries 1933–1956, 22 volumes. Provincetown Art Association and Museum, gift of 2016. Cited through Madeleine Larson's typescript, Parts I–V, 389 pages, by part and page, as the edition's timeline cites them.

The reading

Hopper Ledgers, <https://hopper.commutator.io>. Transcriptions of the six ledgers (46 batches, 543 sheets) and the four notebooks, first machine pass by Claude Opus 5 and Claude Fable 5.1, 5 to 13 September 2026, unchecked against the photographs by a person except where a leaf's note says otherwise. The `.tex` under `transcripts/` is the source of record; the tables in the appendix are read from `src/content/`. Method: `/method/`; Book IV's reader: `docs/book-iv-method.md`; the glossary of forms: `/schema/`.

Every citation in this draft names the leaf as numbered on the paper and the Whitney's ResourceSpace reference for the photograph. A sheet is at `hopper.commutator.io/` followed by the volume, a hash, and the volume, batch and ref, and its photograph is fetched

Sources

from the museum as it is looked at; nothing of the archive is stored by the edition.

Prior readers

Gail Levin, *Edward Hopper: An Intimate Biography* (1995), written from the diaries; *Edward Hopper: A Catalogue Raisonné* (Whitney Museum of American Art and W. W. Norton, 1995), written from the record books.

Deborah Lyons, *Edward Hopper: A Journal of His Work* (Whitney Museum of American Art and W. W. Norton, 1997), the record books published.

Madeleine Larson, typed transcripts of Josephine Hopper's diaries, Parts I–V, Provincetown Art Association and Museum.

Museum records cited

The Art Institute of Chicago, 1942.51 (Nighthawks), 1939.2082 (The Evening Wind), 1923.305 (East Side Interior); The Metropolitan Museum of Art, 25.31.1–15 (fifteen etchings, Harris Brisbane Dick Fund, 1925), the Hearn Fund purchase of 1931 (Tables for Ladies); The Museum of Modern Art, 3.1930 (House by the Railroad); Yale University Art Gallery, 1961.18.29 (Rooms by the Sea); Des Moines Art Center, 1958.2 (Automat). Each was retrieved by the edition's `scripts/works.mjs` from the museum's own API and checked against the artist field; the per-work notes in `work-notes.json` carry the retrieval date.

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